

Tamil Cinema in the Twenty-First Century

Tamil Cinema in the Twenty-First Century explores the current state of Tamil cinema, one of India's largest film industries. Since its inception a century ago, Tamil cinema has undergone major transformations, and today it stands as a foremost cultural institution that profoundly shapes Tamil culture and identity. This book investigates the structural, ideological, and societal cleavages that continue to be reproduced, new ideas, modes of representation and narratives that are being created, and the impact of new technologies on Tamil cinema. It advances a critical interdisciplinary approach that challenges the narratives of Tamil cinema to reveal the social forces at work.

Selvaraj Velayutham is Associate Professor in the Department of Sociology, Macquarie University, Australia.

Vijay Devadas is Associate Professor in the School of Communication Studies, Auckland University of Technology, New Zealand.

Media, Culture and Social Change in Asia

Series Editor

Stephanie Hemelryk Donald

Editorial Board:

Gregory N. Evon, University of New South Wales

Devleena Ghosh, University of Technology, Sydney

Peter Horsfield, RMIT University, Melbourne

Chris Hudson, RMIT University, Melbourne

Michael Keane, Curtin University

Tania Lewis, RMIT University, Melbourne

Vera Mackie, University of Wollongong

Kama Maclean, University of New South Wales

Laikwan Pang, Chinese University of Hong Kong

Gary Rawnsley, Aberystwyth University

Ming-yeh Rawnsley, School of Oriental and African Studies, University of London

Jo Tacchi, Lancaster University

Adrian Vickers, University of Sydney

Jing Wang, MIT

Ying Zhu, City University of New York

The aim of this series is to publish original, high-quality work by both new and established scholars in the West and the East, on all aspects of media, culture and social change in Asia.

For a full list of available titles please visit: <https://www.routledge.com/Media-Culture-and-Social-Change-in-Asia-Series/book-series/SE0797>

67. Ethnic Minority Children in Post-Socialist Chinese Cinema

Allegory, Identity and Geography

Zhenhui Yan

68. The Chinese Internet

The Online Public Sphere, Power Relations and Political Communication

Qingning Wang

69. Tamil Cinema in the Twenty-First Century

Caste, Gender, and Technology

Edited by Selvaraj Velayutham and Vijay Devadas

Tamil Cinema in the Twenty-First Century

Caste, Gender, and Technology

**Edited by
Selvaraj Velayutham and Vijay Devadas**

First published 2021
by Routledge
2 Park Square, Milton Park, Abingdon, Oxon OX14 4RN

and by Routledge
52 Vanderbilt Avenue, New York, NY 10017

Routledge is an imprint of the Taylor & Francis Group, an informa business

© 2021 selection and editorial matter, Selvaraj Velayutham and Vijay
Devadas; individual chapters, the contributors

The right of Selvaraj Velayutham and Vijay Devadas to be identified as
the authors of the editorial material, and of the authors for their individual
chapters, has been asserted in accordance with sections 77 and 78 of the
Copyright, Designs and Patents Act 1988.

All rights reserved. No part of this book may be reprinted or reproduced or
utilised in any form or by any electronic, mechanical, or other means, now
known or hereafter invented, including photocopying and recording, or in
any information storage or retrieval system, without permission in writing
from the publishers.

Trademark notice: Product or corporate names may be trademarks or
registered trademarks, and are used only for identification and explanation
without intent to infringe.

British Library Cataloguing-in-Publication Data

A catalogue record for this book is available from the British Library

Library of Congress Cataloging-in-Publication Data

A catalog record has been requested for this book

ISBN: 978-0-367-19901-2 (hbk)

ISBN: 978-0-429-24402-5 (ebk)

Typeset in Times New Roman
by Deanta Global Publishing Services, Chennai, India

For Leela & Ravi



Taylor & Francis

Taylor & Francis Group

<http://taylorandfrancis.com>

Contents

<i>List of figures</i>	ix
<i>List of tables</i>	x
<i>List of contributors</i>	xi
<i>Acknowledgements</i>	xiv
<i>Foreword: A refreshing look at Tamil cinema</i>	xv
Introduction: Tamil cinema in the twenty-first century: continuities and changes	1
SELVARAJ VELAYUTHAM AND VIJAY DEVADAS	
PART 1	
Caste	17
1 Contested narratives: Filmic representations of North Chennai in contemporary Tamil cinema	19
KARTHIKEYAN DAMODARAN AND HUGO GORRINGE	
2 Conscripts of cinema: The dangerous and deviant Third Wave	36
DICKENS LEONARD	
3 Being Dalit, being Tamil: The politics of <i>Kabali</i> and <i>Kaala</i>	52
KARTHICK RAM MANOHARAN	
PART 2	
Gender	67
4 When Madhi dances like Dhanush: Gender representations in <i>Irudhi Suttru</i>	69
SHAKILA ZAMBOULINGAME	

5	Redefining the mass hero: The rise of the engineer as ‘hero’ in contemporary Tamil cinema	84
	VASUGI KAILASAM	
6	White is the new brown: Constructing Amy Jackson as a desirable object in Tamil cinema	99
	MEENAATCHI SAVERIMUTTU	
7	Misogyny: A content analysis of break-up songs in Tamil films	115
	PREMALATHA KARUPIAH	
8	Religiously middle class: <i>Amman</i> films and the new middle class in contemporary Tamil Nadu	130
	LISA BLAKE	
PART 3		
	Technology	145
9	Will the real Kollywood fan please stand up? Tamil film fandom in the new millennium	147
	ROOS GERRITSEN	
10	Post-millennial Tamil cinema: Transitional generation and the traces of continuity	161
	SWARNAVEL ESWARAN	
11	A rumble in the movie halls: Cinema in the ‘orphaned’ state	179
	MAYA RANGANATHAN	
12	Tamil platform cinema	194
	VIJAY DEVADAS AND SELVARAJ VELAYUTHAM	
	<i>Index</i>	209

Figures

0.1	Still from the film <i>Pariyerum Perumal</i> (Horse Mounting Deity, 2018) featuring actor Kathir in the role of Pariyerum Perumal. Courtesy Gnanam	4
0.2	Still from <i>Aramm</i> (Virtue, 2017) featuring actor Nayanthara as District Collector Madhivadhani. Courtesy Gnanam	5
0.3	Still from the film <i>Super Deluxe</i> featuring actor Vijay Sethupathi as Shilpa. Courtesy Gnanam	7
4.1	Still from <i>Irudhi Suttru</i> (The Final Round, 2016) featuring actors Ritika Singh (Madhi) and Madhavan (Prabhu). Courtesy Gnanam	71
9.1	Capturing the celebrations of the release of <i>Petta</i> (Hood, 2019) and <i>Viswasam</i> (Faith, 2019) at Rohini Theatre, Chennai. Credits Roos Gerritsen, 2019	148
10.1	Screenshot from the film <i>Pisaasu</i> (Ghost, 2014). Courtesy of Director Mysskin	170
10.2	Screenshot from the film <i>Aadukalam</i> (Playground, 2011). Courtesy Director Vetrimaaran	173
10.3	<i>Taramani</i> (2017) film poster. Courtesy Director Ram	175

Tables

4.1	Typical boxing movie and <i>Irudhi Suttru</i> 's narratives comparison	77
7.1	List of songs	119
7.2	Words used to describe a woman/women	120
7.3	References to women's bodies	121
7.4	Lines that vilify all women	125

Contributors

Lisa Blake is a doctoral candidate at McGill University's School of Religious Studies. Her current research, which was made possible through a doctoral scholarship from the Fonds de Recherche du Québec – Société et Culture (FRQSC), focuses on the late-nineteenth-century development of a Tamil-language print tradition for the goddess Māriyamman. She has taught at McGill University in Montreal, Canada, and at St. Michael's College in Vermont, USA.

Karthikeyan Damodaran is Assistant Professor of Asian Studies at the School of Creative Liberal Education, Jain (deemed-to-be) University, Bangalore. His research interests include Dalit politics, caste, commemorations, Urban Cultures, and Tamil Cinema. He is the author of numerous articles on Dalit politics and Tamil Cinema.

Vijay Devadas is Associate Professor in the School of Communication Studies at Auckland University of Technology. His research is focused on the interface of media–culture–society, and his publications address key social, cultural, and political debates and issues across cultures and media platforms. His publications explore indigenous media in Aotearoa; Tamil cinema, media, and neoliberal politics; and media, terror, and sovereignty.

Swarnavel Eswaran is Associate Professor in both English and Media and Information Departments at Michigan State University. His research focuses on the history, theory, and production of documentaries and the specificity of Tamil cinema and its complex relationship with Hollywood as well as popular Hindi films. His recent books are *Cinema: Sattagamum Saalaramum* (2013), an anthology of essays in Tamil on documentaries and experimental films, and *Madras Studios: Narrative, Genre, and Ideology in Tamil Cinema* (2015). He is an accomplished film-maker, and his recent documentaries include *Nagapattinam: Waves from the Deep* (2018), *Hmong Memories at the Crossroad* (2016), *Migrations of Islam* (2014), *Unfinished Journey: A City in Transition* (2012), and *Kattumaram* (2019).

Roos Gerritsen has worked for over 15 years as an anthropologist at Leiden University and Heidelberg University. Her work on Tamil fan clubs and visibility has been published with AUP (2019) as *Intimate Visualities and the Politics of Fandom in India*. She has also published in *Ethnos* and *Visual Anthropology*. Currently, she is working in the fields of smart city, food, and migration in different capacities. She has started her own company that guides cities, organisations and companies with social innovation projects.

Hugo Gorringe is Senior Lecturer in Sociology and the Co-Director of the Centre for South Asian Studies at the University of Edinburgh. His research focuses on the interplay between caste, politics, and Dalit movements in Tamil Nadu. He is the author of *Untouchable Citizens* (2005) and *Panthers in Parliament: Dalits, Caste and Political Power in South India*, as well as numerous articles or chapters on identity, violence, space, caste, and politics. Having grown up in Tamil Nadu, he has a long-standing interest in Tamil cinema.

Vasugi Kailasam is currently Assistant Professor (Tamil Studies) in the Department of South and South East Asian Studies at the University of California, Berkeley. Her research concerns postcolonial literature and the cultures of contemporary South Asia. Specifically, her work examines global Tamil literatures and visual cultures and focuses particularly on narrative form and its connections to South Asian cultural identity formations, race, and ethnic politics.

Premalatha Karupiah is Associate Professor of Sociology at the School of Social Sciences, Universiti Sains Malaysia, Penang, Malaysia. She teaches research methodology and statistics. Her research interests are in the areas of beauty, culture, femininity, educational and occupational choices, and issues related to the Indian diaspora. Her articles have been published in leading journals.

Dickens Leonard presently teaches at the Centre for Comparative Literature, University of Hyderabad, India. For his PhD, he researched on the writings of the nineteenth-century Tamil intellectual Iyothee Thass at UoH. He recently received the Fulbright post-doc grant (2020–2021), and he plans to work on a monograph titled ‘Ethical Dimension of Caste-less Community’ that extends his PhD in the United States. He was formerly a DAAD-visiting PhD fellow (2016) at the Centre for Modern Indian Studies, Georg-August University, Goettingen, Germany. He has published on contemporary Tamil Films as well as on anti-caste thought in renowned journals such as *SAPC*, *EPW*, and *Social Scientist*.

Karthick Ram Manoharan is Assistant Professor of Political Science at the Centre for Studies in Social Sciences, Calcutta (CSSSC). He is the author of *Frantz Fanon: Identity and Resistance* (2019) and a co-editor of the volume *Rethinking Social Justice* (2020). He is currently working on the political thought of Periyar E.V. Ramasamy.

Maya Ranganathan is a media researcher currently working at Macquarie University, Sydney. Her area of specialisation is South Asian media, particularly Indian media. She has co-authored two books on Indian media: *Indian Media in the Age of Globalisation* (2010) and *News Media* (2015). She has published extensively in academic journals on media and political communication in India. Her work draws from over a decade's experience as a journalist in Chennai, India, during which time she also wrote on Tamil cinema.

Meenaatchi Saverimuttu is a PhD candidate at Macquarie University under the supervision of Dr Jane Simon. Her research interests include film studies, gender and queer studies, postcolonial theory, and audience studies. Meenaatchi's doctoral thesis focuses on the unique convergence of genre, narrative, and reality in Tamil films, called cinematic excess, and examines how these excessive characteristics call for a new approach to cinema, unaddressed by Western film studies.

Selvaraj Velayutham is Associate Professor in the Department of Sociology, Macquarie University. His research interests are in race and ethnic relations, Tamil transnational migration, and the sociology of everyday life. He is the editor of *Tamil Cinema: The Cultural Politics of India's Other Film Industry* (2008) and has published widely on Tamil cinema and Tamil diaspora and transnationalism.

Shakila Zamboulingame is a doctoral student and a history/geography professor in Paris. Her thesis project is a study on women's representations in Tamil cinema through gender studies and cultural studies. She is especially interested in examining the evolution of female characters in recent Tamil cinema. Since 2016, she has run a blog on the analysis of Tamil cinema named *1916, About Tamil Cinema*: <https://1916tamilcinema.wordpress.com>. Her other research interests include war photojournalism and visual culture in contemporary societies.

Acknowledgements

It is now 12 years since the edited volume on *Tamil Cinema: The Cultural Politics of India's Other Film Industry* (2008) was published. A groundbreaking book in many ways, it was the first compendium of scholarly work on Tamil cinema that brought together new writings on various aspects of Tamil cinema to a global readership. It provided an overview of the history of the Tamil film industry and critical insights into the social role, representations, and cultural meanings and circulation of Tamil films. Since then, the Tamil film industry, audience, and Tamil society have undergone major transformations. This long-overdue second edited volume interrogates the continuities and changes taking place in Tamil cinema.

We would like to thank Peter Sowden at Routledge, who has been extremely supportive of both book projects. We want to thank all the contributors in this volume. We are especially proud that we have an equal number of genders contributing as well as a whole bunch of emerging scholars. We are also delighted to bring together the works of Indian and international scholars on Tamil cinema. We would like to acknowledge Indira Arumugam, Maunaguru Sidharthan, Lavanya Balachandran, and Rajan Krishnan for their editorial assistance; Swarnavel Eswaran for his comments on the introduction; and Lewis Rarm for his excellent research assistance. We are honoured that the eminent Tamil cinema historian Theodore Baskaran accepted our invitation to write the foreword to the book. We would like to thank our respective institutions, colleagues, and last but not least our families for their continued encouragement and support for this project.

Foreword

A refreshing look at Tamil cinema

S. Theodore Baskaran

Historically, cinema in India was stigmatised as a plebeian preoccupation and did not receive any serious examination. During the freedom struggle, leaders like Gandhi and Rajaji despised cinema. E.V. Ramasamy Naicker also did not hide his contempt for it. The academia in Tamil Nadu too did not see cinema as a worthy scholarly pursuit.

My own interest in Tamil cinema began in the mid-1970s when I received an Indian government research fellowship to document the origins and pioneers of the Tamil film industry. I conducted archival work at the Film and Television Institute of India in Pune and the Tamil Nadu Archives in Chennai and published *The Message Bearers: Nationalist Politics and the Entertainment Media in South India 1880–1945* in 1981. By this time cinema had completely taken over Tamil Nadu and M.G. Ramachandran had become the chief minister. This phenomenon of star-politician and the interaction between cinema and politics in Tamil Nadu attracted the attention of some scholars that include Robert Hardgrave, C.S. Lakshmi, M.S.S. Pandian, and Sivathamby Karthigesu. Later, Venkatesh Chakravarthy, Sarah Dickey, Lalitha Gopalan, and Stephen Hughes interrogated the cultural and social aspects of Tamil cinema. Selvaraj Velayutham's (2008) *Tamil Cinema: The Cultural Politics of India's Other Film Industry* was an important publication that helped propel greater interest in the study of Tamil cinema. This new volume is further testament to the expansion of Tamil cinema research by both Indian and international scholars.

Though Tamil cinema has remained predominantly in entertainment mode, in the past two decades one can observe a measured change in both form and content. The two persistent characteristics of this cinema – orality and frontality, both hangovers from company drama days – are beginning to disappear. The easy availability of foreign films in CD forms and the internet have helped the change in the scene. The influence of Korean, Iranian, and Latin American films has also been a factor in bringing about a change. Miniaturisation of equipment like lights, camera, and digital photography has greatly helped film-makers to move out of the studio context. This physical freedom has also helped them venture into new areas in terms of content. Dalit issues have been handled in a number of films such as Rajiv Menon's *Sarvam Thaala Mayam* (2018). An iconoclastic approach to life has been celebrated cinematically in Thiagarajan Kumarajara's

Super Deluxe (2019). Politically conscious and articulate film-makers like Pa. Ranjith, Vetrimaaran of *Asuran* (2019), and Mari Selvaraj of *Pariyerum Perumal* (2018) fame are active on the scene now.

The 12 essays in the book, by young scholars from all over the world, focus on various aspects of contemporary Tamil cinema, including gender, class, caste, religion, fandom, generational change, and the arrival of the digital age. They bring refreshingly different approaches to screen studies like never before. What makes them authentic is that a lot of Tamil sources have been tapped. Traditionally, academic works on Tamil cinema depended on English sources and to that extent were limited in their dimensions. The Malayalam film-maker Shaji Karun said: ‘the language of cinema is discovering itself. A hundred years is practically nothing for any art form’. Being such a young art form, theoreticians are constantly in the debate on the nature of cinema and on the direction it is going. The set of sparkling new essays contained in this collection offers some hints into what is ahead.

S. Theodore Baskaran

Tamil cinema historian

Introduction

Tamil cinema in the twenty-first century: continuities and changes

Selvaraj Velayutham and Vijay Devadas

Cinema, India, centenary

The year 2013 marked the centenary of cinema in India, following the screening of the first Indian silent film *Raja Harishchandra* (The King Harishchandra) on 3 May 1913 at Coronation Theatre in what was then Bombay. Numerous events were held across the globe to celebrate the birth and honour the achievements of the Indian film industry. It is instructive that these commemorations were bestowed upon the Hindi language cinema, popularly known as Bollywood, thus constituting Indian cinema as Mumbai-centred and all else as regional. The centenary was dominated by a refusal to discuss and deliberate other histories, stories, and creative practices that disrupt the normalised understanding of the centenary. As Bhaskaran (2013) observes, ‘the centenary of Indian cinema is fast being reduced to a celebration of Hindi films, largely Bollywood’.

That said, the South Indian Film Chambers of Commerce (SIFCC) organised a state-sponsored four-day event in Chennai in September 2013 to honour its own personalities from the Malayalam, Tamil, Telugu, and Kannada film industries to mark the centenary of Indian cinema. This is an interesting juxtaposition for the Tamil film industry whose foundational claim has been based on its linguistic and cultural difference encapsulated by a long period of Dravidian-based films (see Hardgrave 1973; Pandian 1992; Devadas and Velayutham 2008). The point is that the state-funded centenary celebration is one amongst other possible centenaries of Tamil cinema – the first Tamil silent film *Keechaka Vadham* (The Extermination of Keechaka) was released in 1918 – and importantly that centenary celebrations exemplify how cinema, its histories, became an institution for the state to articulate its identity. In Chennai it became the ideal platform to articulate the significance of the contribution of cinema from the South to Indian cinema to underscore the importance of using cinema to advance Dravidian culture and politicise film culture. At the celebrations, the then Chief Minister Jayalalitha, for example, also took the opportunity to note that the Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (Dravidian Progressive Federation, DMK) had a stranglehold on Tamil cinema for a long time until her party, the All India Anna Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (AIADMK), came into power and enabled cinema to thrive.

It can be argued that the Bollywood/Hindi cinema's disregard for the particular histories and contributions of South Indian/Tamil cinema to the corpus of Indian cinema is also evidenced by the limited engagement with these cinemas in Indian scholarship. Commonly labelled as *regional cinema*, Tamil and other non-Hindi language cinemas remain in the shadows of Bollywood in terms of popularity and academic research. Statistically though, more than 200 Tamil films are produced every year, including multilingual and dubbed films in Tamil Nadu, and the Southern Indian cinemas (Tamil and Telugu combined) generate as much revenue as Bollywood. Most recently, the historic drama *Bahubali: The Beginning* (2015) and *Bahubali: The Conclusion* (2019), which were shot in Telugu and Tamil, became the highest-grossing films ever in India, ushering a new interest for and recognition of the South Indian cinemas. The YouTube music video 'Why This Kolaveri Di?' (2011) by actor/singer Dhanush and produced by Anirudh became one of the most streamed songs of all time and went viral and resulted in a countless number of copy versions sung in other languages across the globe. The iconic 'superstar' Rajinikanth, who primarily acts in Tamil cinema, has remained the highest-paid actor in India for well over two decades. And the Tamil music composer, Oscar and Grammy award-winner, A.R. Rahman, who is referred to as the 'Mozart of Madras', is a global phenomenon. In another first for the Tamil film industry, *Kochadaiiyan* (The King with the Curly Mane, 2014) became India's first photorealistic motion capture film depicting the appearance and likeness of their respective actors. The creativity of those involved in Tamil cinema crosses linguistic, cultural, social, and cultural borders, and in that sense, it is a global cultural industry. As such, understanding the economic and cultural contribution and significance of this cinema is thus long overdue.

Tamil cinema in the new millennium

More than a decade ago, Velayutham (2008) published *Tamil Cinema: The Cultural Politics of India's Other Film Industry* to draw attention to this globally less-known Indian cultural industry. The book provided an overview of the history of the Tamil film industry and cinema and critical insights into the social role, representations, and cultural meaning and circulation of films of Tamil Nadu. It also examined cinema as a vehicle for the propagation of Tamil language, culture, and identity; a platform for Dravidian/Tamil ethno-linguistic nationalism and political ascendancy; and a medium for reproducing patriarchal, class, and casteist privileges and sometimes challenging these normalising tendencies and giving voice to the marginalised and underprivileged.

In recent years, Tamil cinema itself has undergone a generational change with the entry of new and young film practitioners reaching out to a millennial audience, a shift in the technologies used, and a dispersal of the platform of screening. As we enter the third decade of the twenty-first century, it is an opportune time to revisit some of the persistent themes and indeed explore emerging trends within Tamil cinema. *Tamil Cinema in the Twenty-First Century* critically engages with the continuities that dominate Tamil cinema and identifies the transformations to ascertain the

impact of these changes and speculate the future of this film industry. Do old forms of structural and societal cleavages like gender, class, caste, and ethnicity, political affiliation, urban and rural, locality, regionality, and nationality loom large? Are they being transformed, challenged, and renegotiated? What new ideas, modes of representation, and narratives are being created? How are new technologies impacting Tamil cinema in terms of production, distribution, and consumption?

To this end, we sent out a *call for papers*, inviting Tamil cinema scholars to contribute to this volume on *Tamil Cinema in the Twenty-First Century*. We anticipated that we would receive a variety of papers reflecting the diversity of Tamil cinema itself. But to our surprise, the submissions we received fell neatly into three broad categories – *caste*, *gender*, and *technology* – which thus appear in the subtitles. The specific interest in these topics/themes is indicative of their significance within Tamil culture and society and Tamil cinema. For instance, we know in recent years at least that caste conflict and the politicisation of caste are in the ascendancy; gender discrimination and violence continues to haunt Indian society; and, finally, India's technological and digital transformations are profoundly reconfiguring everyday life. These issues are obviously not new concerns for scholars of India. They are central to this book precisely because Tamil cinema scholars are intent on exposing the historical continuities and perpetuation of caste and gender violence/inequalities; new representations of caste and gender identities; and technological advances both enabling and proliferating new modes of production, circulation, and consumption of Tamil cinema. At the same time, we want to emphasise that other forces too are influencing cinema: patriarchy, India's economic expansion, the rise of the middle class, Hindu fundamentalism, corruption and red tape, rampant urbanisation, ecological disasters, and an exponential growth of media and communication industries. Their impact on filmic text and representation can also be gleaned in the arguments presented in the chapters. Here we offer a snippet of the recurring themes and new developments specific to Tamil cinema:

- A key development in Tamil cinema recently has been the emergence and success of Dalit-themed films which were previously ignored. According to the noted Dalit film-maker, Pa. Ranjith, the absence of Dalit film-makers and Dalit-themed films can be attributed to the ideological leanings of the Tamil film industry, for whom

everything is seen from the perspective of business. People want their films to be sold. Dalit-themed films are not being made more often because several attempts in the past have failed to interest the audience. It's a very biased industry, and film-makers fear the restrictions they have to face.

(Pudipeddi, 2019)

Dalit-themed films were initiated by Pa. Ranjith with *Attakathi* (Cardboard Knife, 2012), *Madras* (2014), *Kabali* (2016), and *Kaala* (Black or Death,

2018) directed by him, and *Pariyerum Perumal* (Horse Mounting Deity, 2018), produced by him, is part of Tamil cinema's evolution in its treatment of caste (Figure 0.1). And director Vetrimaaran's *Asuran* (The Demon, 2019) about a Dalit community, loosely based on the pre-eminent Tamil (Dalit) writer Poomani's novel *Vekkai* (Heat, 1982), was influenced by the Kilvenmani massacre that occurred in 1968 in the Thanjavur District. It would be remiss to conclude that the success of Dalit-themed films signals that casteism is not an issue in the Tamil film industry and Tamil society. The chapters by Damodaran and Gorringe, Leonard, and Manoharan in this volume demonstrate that caste dynamics and the representation of Dalits in Tamil cinema remains a contested issue.

- Tamil cinema continues to perpetuate a hegemonic masculinist discourse, reflected in the continued dominance of male heroes such as Rajinikanth, Kamal Haasan, Vijay, Vikram, Ajith, and Surya and the perpetuation of a mass-hero culture, which began with M.G. Ramachandran (MGR). The mass heroes 'are portrayed as supermen able to do many things at a time — things they are otherwise incapable of, like talking in many languages, singing, dancing, fighting, handling weapons, etc.' (Jesudoss 2009). The mass heroes in their role as vigilantes or police officers act as moral crusaders and fight injustices. At the same time, as Leonard and Kailasam demonstrate in their chapters, new forms of masculinities are starting to appear in Tamil cinema — the angry and deviant; the educated, middle-class, urbane, and metrosexual male.



Figure 0.1 Still from the film *Pariyerum Perumal* (Horse Mounting Deity, 2018) featuring actor Kathir in the role of Pariyerum Perumal. Courtesy Gnanam.

- While Tamil cinema remains patriarchal, dominated by male heroes, and has a penchant for hero-centred narrative actors, the industry has in recent years released a number of women-centric films, including *Magalir Mattum* (Ladies Only, 2017), *Aramm* (Virtue, 2017), *Irudhi Suttru* (The Final Round, 2016), *Aruvi* (Stream, 2016), *Amma Kanakku* (Mother's Calculations, 2016), and *36 Vayadhinile* (At the Age of 36, 2015) (Figure 0.2). The re-emergence of this genre, which was the hallmark of directors such as K. Balachander and Balu Mahendra in the 1970s, has been lauded by reporters and directors such as Anita Udeep and Lakshmy Ramakrishnan and actors such as Amala Paul. For them, women-centric films go against the dominant patriarchal representational tropes of portraying women in Tamil cinema that glorify stalking and normalise body shaming (Poorvaja, 2019). While the rise of women-centric films must be celebrated and has been framed as feminist films by Krishnakumar (2017), for example, who writes, 'to me, simply by virtue of placing women at the front and centre, these films are somewhat feminist', it must be noted that while this is a welcome difference, the majority of



Figure 0.2 Still from *Aramm* (Virtue, 2017) featuring actor Nayanthara as District Collector Madhivadhani. Courtesy Gnanam.

commercial Tamil films continue to subscribe to misogynistic, patriarchal, and reductive representation of women as suggested by Zamboulingame, Saverimuttu, Karupiah, and Blake in this volume.

- While positive depictions and the empowerment of women in Tamil cinema are emerging and remain tenuous, the same cannot be said of the lesbian, gay, bisexual, and transgender (LGBT) community or transgender subjects (*Thirunangai* and *Aravani* in Tamil). LGBT characters are virtually absent in Tamil cinema, and where they do appear in films such as *Thiruda Thirudi* (Thief Thief, 2003), *Thirupaachi* (2005), and *Paruthiveeran* (Cotton Champ, 2007), transgender characters are insulted and ridiculed. They are ostracised from their families, engage in sex work, or act as a source of self-gratification (Mangayarkkarasi 2019). As Priya Babu, the head of Transgender Resource Centre in Madurai, points out, Tamil cinema ‘rarely speak of topics such as jobs, education and transgender love’ (*The Hindu*, 2017). Films such as *Narthagi* (Female Dancer, 2011) and *Paal* (Milk, 2016) feature transgender subjects in a positive light, but an ‘A’ censor rating (screenings are limited to those over 18 years old at restricted venues) and poor commercial success have made them unnoteworthy. In *Pariyerum Perumal*, the protagonist’s father is a folk dancer who performs in drag. As activist and transwoman, Kanaga Varthan (2018) observes, ‘*Pariyerum Perumal* is an honest attempt to humanize gender non-conforming individuals and appeal to a mainstream heteronormative audience’. A more recent film *Super Deluxe* (2019) (Figure 0.3) draws the audience into the world of Shilpa, who has undergone gender change surgery and returns home to a shell-shocked family. But her son and wife embrace her for who she is. As she navigates the outside world accompanying her son to school, the audience bears witness to the unease, abhorrence, intimidation, suspicion, and sexual abuse experienced by transgender persons on the streets. The film is pathbreaking for the journey we take is through her eyes, a rarity in Tamil cinema, which enables us to affectively connect with how a transgender person navigates a society that views gender only in binary terms. This is a significant first step in the portrayal of Thirunangais and Aravanis in a commercially successful Tamil film.
- Tamil cinema continues to be dominated by big-budget masala films. The production cost of *Raavanan* (Ravana, 2010), for example, was estimated at Rs. 55 crores by IMDb (Internet Movie Database) and that of *Thuppakki* (Gun, 2012) at Rs. 65 crores, while *Kaala* (Black or Death, 2018) starring Rajinikanth was made on a budget of Rs. 80 crores. While it goes without saying that big-budget films are not necessarily profitable, it is worth noting that in 2019 the three most profitable films were *Viswasam* (Faith), *Petta* (Hood), and *Kanchana 3*, ‘big-budget extravaganzas made by established production houses’ (Pillai, 2019). This is precisely why production houses such as Eros and Fox Star Studios have entered into the regional film industry, begun producing Tamil films, and entered into partnership with established Tamil film producers and directors. In 2011, Fox Star Studios, in partnership with A.R.



Figure 0.3 Still from the film *Super Deluxe* featuring actor Vijay Sethupathi as Shilpa. Courtesy Gnanam.

Murugadoss, produced *Engaeyum Eppothum* (Anywhere, Anytime) and in 2013 released *Vathikuchi* (Matchstick).

- While established production houses continue to dominate the Tamil screen-scape, the Tamil screen ecology is undergoing a transformation enabled by digital technologies and platform multiplicity. As discussed by Devadas and Velayutham (in this volume), digital developments have engendered new modes of production, distribution, and consumption, a proliferation of films and amateur creativity. Additionally, the circulation of Tamil films has transformed for theatres are no longer the only platform for distribution: the entry Over-the-Top (OTT) and streaming services and the Direct-to-Home (DTH) platform have facilitated the dispersal of cinema into small screens. The expanded distribution networks have enabled the creativity of amateur film-makers to flourish, broken down the hegemony of production houses, and fostered the possibility of exploring issues and topics beyond those seen previously in Tamil cinema. At the same time, there has been a backlash to this, witnessed, for example, in 2013, when Kamal Haasan sought to release *Vishwaroopam* on the DTH platform a day before the theatrical release, and exhibitors and distributors threatened to boycott the film. This compelled a compromise, and the film was subsequently released on DTH one week after its theatrical release.
- While the Tamil screen ecology is shifting, enabling a more divergent Tamil cinematic landscape to emerge, the commercial Tamil cinema circuit remains highly regulated by a complex crony-capitalist network that

controls production, circulation, and distribution; a symbiotic association with political parties and politicians; a culture of favouritism and gatekeepers regulating opportunities; and rampant nepotism. These, coupled with a commercial cinematic culture that promotes big-budget films, with familiar stars, narratives pandering to the mainstream audiences, and abeyance to the masala genre, provide little opportunities for documentarians and amateur and independent film-makers to break into the commercial circuit. The films of Leena Manimekalai (*Maadathy*, An Unfair Tale, 2019; *Sengadal*, The Red Sea, 2011), Dharani Rajendran (*Gnanaserukku*, Pride of Wisdom, 2018), S.P.P. Bhaskaran (*Insha Allah*, God Willing, 2019), Vaishnavi Sundar (*Pava*, 2014), Divya Bharathi (*Kakkoos*, Toilet, 2017), and Swarnavel Eswaran (*Kattumaram*, Catamaran, 2019; *Nagapattinam: Waves from the Deep*, 2018), to name but a few, struggle for visibility in the commercial scene because the subject matters they engage with do not conform to the norms of the commercial film industry. Take for instance Manimekalai's feature film *Maadathy*, which is about the Puthirai Vannar community who occupy the lowest in Dalit hierarchy. Using members from the community as the cast, it powerfully engages with gender and caste-based violence that the community confronts on a daily basis. This uncompromising and realistic film premiered at the 2019 Busan International Film Festival in South Korea, but it has not made any inroads into the commercial Tamil cinema circuit.

- In essence, while masala films continue to dominate commercial Tamil cinema, a New Wave of Tamil films are making an appearance. These films 'fuse the energy and entertainment of a mainstream film (without its formulaic excesses) with the complexity and sensitivity of an art film (minus the excessive artiness)' (Kalorth 2006, 94). This New Wave, which can be conceptualised as a hybrid genre, relies upon conventional commercial cinema aesthetics and blends this with realism and unknown actors to produce films whose 'visual language ... seems to be real, the cultural and social subtexts are more hinted, which take the audience closer to the character, the violence, romance, [and] rituals' (Kalorth 2006, 92). Films such as *Autograph* (2004), *Kaadhal* (Love, 2004), and the spoof film *Tamizh Padam* (Tamil Film, 2010) are examples of this emerging hybrid genre.
- Finally, the recent decade has witnessed an explosion of Tamil short films which are finding their way into Indian and international film festivals as well as the internet (e.g. YouTube). Short films which are typically produced on a low budget and with affordable technological devices such as a mobile phone have paved the way for parallel screen ecology. As Devadas and Velayutham argue in their chapter, short films are becoming very popular as they are made by young people and watched by their peers.

Thematic overview: continuities and changes

The brief outline we have provided above articulates the tensions that animate Tamil cinema in the new millennium, which are also examined in the papers

selected for this volume: some highlight the role of cinema in the reproduction of dominant ideologies, and others point to the ways in which it is changing perceptions and practices and pushing the boundaries of prevailing social norms.

In his article ‘Dalit Cinema’, Suraj Yengde makes the following observation: ‘the Indian film industry is an inherently caste-based, biased, mechanised product of technological industrialisation in which Dalit inclusion is not a moral concern’ (2018, 503). This is an astute comment that also implicates the Tamil film industry for its complicity in perpetuating the caste system and making ‘invisible’ caste discrimination. Tamil cinema has had a vexed relationship with caste, and, as Devaki (2019) points out, it is not surprising that a canvass of Tamil films confirms that ‘just a few castes and occupational categories are represented and these portrayals scarcely ever compare to real social classifications’. The dominant caste becomes ‘the center of the stage’, and ‘low caste/marginalized/Dalits are not even ... [on] the scene and become voiceless for all this time, heard by none’ (Devaki, 2019). But a spate of recent films is giving voice to low caste and Dalits. The three papers in the first section interrogate the articulation of caste in Tamil cinema, connecting caste discrimination and violence to the spatial politics of lived places and identity construction in contemporary Tamil society. Significantly, the papers underscore caste as a key structuring modality of the social life of Tamils, and which enforce, maintain, and challenge social divisions within Tamil society.

Karthikeyan Damodaran and Hugo Gorringer focus on filmic representations of North Chennai – a recurring site in a number of films in recent years – as its neighbourhoods are undesirable, lack proper working infrastructure, and are a breeding ground for criminal activities. Tamil cinema’s preoccupation with particular spaces and places began in the 1980s and 1990s as the village was celebrated and idealised in nativity films (*Kaali* 2000). Then, the southern city of Madurai and its surrounds were showcased as the hotbed of caste violence and an antithesis to Chennai, depicted as the location of modernity, progress, and cosmopolitanism (Krishnan 2008). The recent interests in North Chennai, as Damodaran and Gorringer argue, ‘cater to a voyeuristic (middle class) audience instantaneously both attracted to, and repulsed by, an imaginary about the ghetto as a zone in need of state intervention (often police violence), explication and transformation’. The stigmatisation of North Chennai and its inhabitants as social outcasts can only be possible because West and South Chennai are imagined as affluent and upper-caste neighbourhoods. Damodaran and Gorringer challenge the problematic representations of North Chennai by highlighting the contested narratives inherent in films like *Madras* (2014), *Vikram Vedha* (2017), and *Vadachennai* (North Chennai, 2018).

Dickens Leonard, in his chapter on conscripts of cinema, shifts our attention from North Chennai to the city of Madurai, which has prefigured as the backdrop for a number of caste-centric films in the post-2000s. He too traces the shifts in the ways in which Tamil cinema addresses its audience. The First Wave challenged the idea of a ‘national’ audience through its assertion of Tamil-ness/Tamil identity. The Second Wave, predominantly in the 1990s, sought to reconfigure

the ‘Tamilian’ as inclusive and inhabiting the national space, especially through Mani Ratnam’s *Roja* (Rose, 1992) and *Bombay* (1995). The Third Wave, which is central to Leonard’s argument, is marked by the recurrence of dangerous and deviant heroes and excess of casteist articulations with the city of Madurai as its main backdrop. Third Wave cinema then is the fetishisation of the anti-hero or angry and downtrodden hero who is indelibly etched as lower caste and criminal.

While Leonard’s Third Wave cinema bears the hallmark of the disdain for the lower caste, Karthick Manoharan’s chapter speaks to the potency of caste politics, especially Dalitism, in his close reading of Rajinikanth starrers *Kabali* (2016) and *Kaala* (Black or Death, 2018), both directed by Pa. Ranjith. While these films were anticipated to be pro-Dalit and represent many symbols of Dalit identity, Manoharan suggests that Pa. Ranjith’s real aim was to convey an alternative progressive Tamil nationalism, which brings together a paradigm of social justice that is inspired by Ambedkarite and Periyarist thoughts. In other words, rather than pursuing Dalit emancipation and empowerment as antagonistic or separate to Tamil identity, according to Manoharan, Pa. Ranjith’s *Kabali* and *Kaala* seek to ‘move from the Dalit location to the Tamil location, refashioning both’.

The second section examines the dynamics of gender politics in Tamil Nadu – subtle pushing of boundaries, reproduction of gender discrimination and violence, and marginalisation of women. Shakila Zamboulingame in her chapter undertakes a close textual and semiotic reading of the film *Irudhi Suttru* (The Final Round, 2016), directed by a woman and the first Tamil boxing film with a female protagonist. The film appears to complicate traditional gender norms and relations as the lead actor, Madhi, is depicted as irreverent and rebellious and constantly questioning traditional notions of Tamil womanhood. However, as Zamboulingame demonstrates, *Irudhi Suttru* is a film that ultimately reinforces the cultural ideals of Tamil femininity (Madhi wears a saree to please her love interest and is subdued by her male coach) as actively complicit in reproducing male domination. For Zamboulingame, *Irudhi Suttru* is not a feminist manifesto, but in the convention of mainstream commercial cinema, male heroism finally overshadows female heroism. The figure of the heroine in Tamil cinema has been widely discussed (Lakshmi 2008; Chinniah 2008). Quite remarkably, as Velayutham (2008) points out, most Tamil cinema heroines, have, for the most part, come from outside Tamil Nadu. The casting of North Indian actors as heroines primarily for their ‘physical beauty’ and sex appeal is now commonplace. Into this mix enters Liverpooldian Amy Jackson who has risen into prominence in the Tamil film industry since her debut in the period-drama *Madrasapattinam* (Madras Town, 2010).

Meenaatchi Saverimuttu in her chapter interrogates the fantasy of Jackson’s femininity (white/Western) and her transformation on screen as an Indian/‘Tamil’ (tanned skin, dark hair, etc.) and posits that ‘while the glorification of Jackson’s fair skin is the obvious reasoning behind her popularity, it is equally matched by Jackson’s Western sensibilities and her willingness to enact in on screen acts that Tamil women may be reluctant to participate in’. The Indian feminist writer C.S. Lakshmi (2008) observes that ‘women in Tamil cinema are obliged to carry their

bodies only in particular ways in clear categories: pure and impure'. Non-Tamil heroines like Amy Jackson are able to perform across these binaries and indulge in the male sexual fantasy, while a Tamil heroine retains her purity both on and off screen.

When a heroine – to safeguard her dignity – rejects the romantic and sexual advances of the hero, she mutates from being an object of desire to an object of hatred. This finds expression in break-up songs, a common storyline of many Tamil films in recent years. Break-up songs are performed by the hero wallowing in the rejection of love under the influence of alcohol. Premalatha Karupiah's content analysis of break-up songs reveals that they are akin to the hate music genre as they vilify and denigrate women. She argues that break-up songs normalise misogyny because the anger and hatred vented out by the hero are represented as legitimate expressions of love. Significantly, because these songs appear in U-certified films, meaning they are available for viewing across all age ranges, the social impact of this is even more acute for the songs perpetuate a masculine understanding of love, relationship, and intimacy. Karupiah's chapter then is another telling example of how women are positioned in Tamil cinema: simultaneously as objects of masculine desire, hate, and anger. Karupiah's chapter reaffirms that Tamil cinema in the millennium continues to perpetuate sexism and misogyny and male chauvinism.

Tamil culture is inherently patriarchal and one in which women's agency is silenced. Lisa Blake in her chapter turns our attention to the genre of *Ammāṇ* or goddess films and in particular their appeal to Tamil Nadu's middle-class women. Blake argues that *Ammāṇ* films are premised on the fear that the new middle class would abandon Indian culture and tradition in favour of materialism and Western cultural influences. In other words, these films seek to entrench Hindu culture as an antidote to neoliberal global culture. While the genre of *Ammāṇ* films has been a feature of Tamil cinema for some time, for Blake, its resurgence in the early 2000s reflects an emerging tension between middle and non-middle classes. This is played out in films that focus on the South Indian village goddess *Māriyamman*, whose supernatural powers enable upwardly mobile middle-class families to negotiate the perceived, manufactured chasm between middle-class mobility, consumption practices, and faith. Through religious faith, the contradiction between material and spiritual growth is reconciled, and women, as Blake suggests, are taught how to be ideal middle-class women, wives, and devotees. The structuring of female subjectivity through this genre ultimately performs a pedagogical task: of teaching Tamil women how to be properly middle class, to strike a balance between material wealth aspirations and religiosity.

The chapter by Vasugi Kailasam examines three Tamil films that focus on what she calls the rise of the engineer hero, a genre that draws on established conventions of the mass hero seen in commercial Tamil films, but which situates the masculine hero as a professional. The latter staging breaks the conventions of the representation of the mass hero as working class but rather as middle class, educated, and urbane. For Kailasam, the new white-collar hero is the product of India's economic liberalisation drive that started in the 1990s. The engineer hero is an embodiment of the neoliberal self – young, enterprising, self-refashioning,

creative, and striving to secure their own future. He is above all a metrosexual, with a lean and ‘toned’ body, and in that instance appears ordinary: the young man next door. This remaking of masculinity can be explained in part by the entry of many new and young actors into an ever-expanding Tamil film industry amidst aging mass heroes and generally appealing to rising middle-class and urban male audiences.

The final section on technology examines the impact of new technologies on different aspects of Tamil cinema: publicity, fandom, narrative, production, and consumption. The aim is to demonstrate how the intersection of digital technologies is transforming the Tamil cinema landscape and enabling a rethinking of Tamil cinema in the new millennium. Given the symbiotic relationship between cinema and politics in Tamil Nadu, Maya Ranganathan explores the multiple ways in which Tamil cinema in the new millennium perpetuates and simultaneously challenges the articulation of structural and social ruptures that are integral to Tamil society. From stage theatre to radio to cinema, technology has been pivotal for mass propagation and thoroughly exploited by the DMK and AIADMK and other aspiring actor-turned politicians. However, Ranganathan argues that the cinema–politics relationship needs to be re-evaluated in light of the fragmentation of the Tamil political landscape following the deaths of the two most powerful Dravidian leaders, Jayalalithaa and Karunanidhi in 2016 and 2018, respectively, the entries of film stars into electoral politics with the promise of an alternative to Dravidian politics, the kinds of films that are being made currently that shift the political public sphere, and the transformations in the business of cinema enabled by new technologies. Through a critical overview of the shifting Tamil cinema ecology, Ranganathan’s chapter sets the ground for future investigations of how to articulate the cinema–politics relationship in Tamil Nadu in the twenty-first century.

The changes in the cinema–politics nexus also play out in the cinema–fandom relationship. Tamil movie fans typically manifest themselves by putting up images of their star in public spaces. From movie releases, their hero’s birthday, or celebratory occasions, fans exhibit myriads of painted cut-outs, vinyl banners, or posters. These relatively ephemeral image technologies are part of the relays between the medium of cinema, which has produced several film star-politicians in Tamil Nadu and street-level appropriations of these iconic figures into more intimate and affective modes of engagement. Roos Gerritsen’s chapter examines these modes of engagement in times of change. Transformations in image technologies, films, and spaces of viewing have changed the cinematic landscape since the 2000s. These transformations have resulted in interruptions and disappointments, as well as new potentials for fans. Drawing on extensive ethnographic fieldwork with fan club members, image-makers, and film theatre staff, Gerritsen explores the ways in which images and image technologies have fashioned fandom in the new millennium. They indicate the shifting perspectives, the coming and going of images, and the different strategies and relationalities that articulate around the film. She argues that instead of considering transformations as part of a neoliberal imaginary, pushing out the more personalised, grassroots use of

images, we have to think in terms of layered articulations that produce a varied array of visual strategies in public spaces.

In the context of Tamil cinema, the discourse surrounding digital technology foregrounds and critiques its schizoid nature; on the one hand, it has democratised the media and has made film-making accessible and affordable, leading to the possibility of engaging with rare subjects hitherto unheard of and experimenting with form; on the other hand, it has led to a spate of films which are often amateurish in terms of their screenplays and production values and technical finesse. In this context, Swarnavel Eswaran shines the spotlight on three film directors who belong to a transitional generation ushering new techniques and explorations through digital technology. He shows how despite such a paradoxical pull at the core of digital cinema, the last decade has seen the intervention of directors who have made a difference to mainstream Tamil cinema. Eswaran closely examines three directors who have carved a niche for themselves within the Tamil film industry as directors who have worked within the mainstream with a style of their own with respect to form and content: Mysskin, Ram, and Vetrimaaran, particularly with respect to their landmark films: *Nandalala* (2010), *Onayum Aattukuttiyum* (The Wolf and the Lamb, 2013), and *Pisaasu* (Ghost, 2014) [director Mysskin]; *Katrathu Tamil* (Tamil Learnt, 2007), *Thangameengal* (Gold Fish, 2013), and *Taramani* (2017) [director Ram]; and *Polladhavan* (Ruthless Man, 2007), *Aaadukalam* (Playground, 2011), and *Visaranai* (Interrogation, 2016) [director Vetrimaaran]. Swarnavel's close reading of these films and directors situates their creativity as one that straddles the transition from celluloid to digital technology, arguing that these key films are enabled because of digital technologies. Put another way, Swarnavel argues that the digital ushers in a new economy of production fosters experimentation of techniques and forms and enables the directors to creatively reinvent established narrative structures in Tamil cinema. It should be noted, as Swarnavel suggests, that the digital should not be equated with a rupture from previous narratives, aesthetics, and forms: rather, the work of these directors marks a transitional moment which draws from the past, that is, era of the celluloid, while ushering a new future enabled by digital technologies.

The final chapter in this section examines the proliferation of Tamil films on YouTube from three key perspectives – production, text, and consumption – and locates this within the larger context of Digital India. Vijay Devadas and Selvaraj Velayutham interrogate how digital technologies (mobile phones, social media, and video-sharing platforms, in this case YouTube) have engendered new modes of production, creativity, texts, and consumption practices, enabling a rethinking of the idea of Tamil films and by extension Tamil cinema. They trace the circuits to demonstrate that the digital intervention has been transformative: it has democratised production, circulation, and consumption and challenged the hegemonic practices of Tamil cinema. At the same time, the authors argue that the YouTube Tamil Film Ecology is intimately connected to the global Tamil cinema industry variously. They critically explore these intimate connections in relation to notions of celebrity culture, film festivals and awards, production, and narrative to argue that while the YouTube Tamil Film Ecology is transformative, it is not distinct or

disconnected from the Tamil cinema juggernaut. Their relationship is much more complicated and complex, intertwined, and distinct. In making this argument, Devadas and Velayutham mobilise the notion of Tamil platform cinema to propose that scholarship on the dispersal of cinema enabled by digital technologies, the proliferation of a micro-screen culture, which articulate this screen ecology as different and new, must be tempered: the example of the YouTube Tamil film ecology tells us that it is both dispersed and connected.

The chapters in this volume offer fresh insights into the work that Tamil cinema is doing today. They are also able to show us vital transformations as well as deep continuities characterising its production processes, aesthetic representations, ideological underpinnings, and the reception of its enjoyable products. Importantly, they represent a growing interest in Tamil cinema scholarship both within and outside Tamil Nadu and make a significant contribution to Indian cinema studies in general.

References

- Bhaskaran, G. 2013. "Mumbai Movies Hog Indian Cinema Centenary Celebrations." *Hindustan Times*, May 17. Accessed 15 February 2020. <https://www.hindustantimes.com/bollywood/mumbai-movies-hog-indian-cinema-centenary-celebrations/story-gNWroysph8JCgceOlglIPN.html>
- Chinniah, S. 2008. "The Tamil Film Heroine: From a Passive Subject to a Pleasurable Object." In *Tamil Cinema: The Cultural Politics of India's Other Film Industry*, edited by Selvaraj Velayutham. New York: Routledge.
- Devaki, V. 2019. "Caste and Tamil Cinema: Now and Then." *Indian Ruminations: Journal of Indian English Writers*, February 5. Accessed 15 February 2020. <https://www.indianruminations.com/contents/articles/caste-and-tamil-cinema-now-and-then-dr-v-devaki-chennai/>
- Hardgrave, R. 1973. "Politics and the Film in Tamilnadu: The Stars and the DMK." *Asian Survey* 13 (3): 288–305.
- The Hindu*. 2017. "Tamil Cinema Portrayed Transgenders in a Bad Light." November 20. Accessed 27 January 2020. <https://www.thehindu.com/news/cities/Madurai/tamil-cinema-portrayedtransgenders-in-a-bad-light/article20559646.ece>
- Jesudoss, P. 2009. "Tamil Cinema." *Communication Research Trends: A Quarterly Review of Communication Research* 28 (4). Accessed 15 February 2020. http://cscs.scu.edu/trends/v28/CRT_v28_n4_Dec2009.pdf
- Kalaroth, N. 2016. "Screen Shifts in Recent Tamil Cinemas: The 'new' New Wave." *Research Scholar: an International Refereed e-Journal of Literary Explorations* 4 (2): 91–97.
- Kapse, A. 2015. "Afterthoughts on the Indian Cinema Centenary." *South Asian Popular Culture* 13 (1): 61–64.
- Krishnakumar, R. 2017. "2017 Was Not the Perfect Year for Feminism in Tamil Cinema, but It Was a Great Beginning." *Scroll.in*, December 30. Accessed 15 February 2020. <https://scroll.in/reel/863130/2017-was-not-the-perfect-year-for-feminism-in-tamil-cinema-but-it-was-a-great-beginning>

- Krishnan, R. 2008. "Imaginary Geographies: The Making of the 'South' in Contemporary Tamil Cinema." In *Tamil Cinema: The Cultural Politics of India's Other Film Industry*, edited by Selvaraj Velayutham. New York: Routledge.
- Lakshmi, C.S. 2008. "A Good Woman, a Very Good Woman: Tamil Cinema's Women." In *Tamil Cinema: The Cultural Politics of India's Other Film Industry*, edited by Selvaraj Velayutham. New York: Routledge.
- Mangayarkkarasi, M. 2019. "Portrayal of Transgender People in Tamil Cinema." *Research Review: International Journal of Multidisciplinary* 4 (2): 669–672.
- NDTV. 2013. "Jayalalithaa Felicitates Tamil Film Legends at Indian Cinema Centenary Fete." *NDTV*, September 22. Accessed 15 February 2020. <https://www.ndtv.com/south/jayalalithaa-felicitates-tamil-film-legends-at-indian-cinema-centenary-fete-535336>
- Pandian, M.S.S. 1992. *The Image Trap: M.G. Ramachandran in Film and Politics*. New Delhi: Newbury Park.
- Patel, R. 2013. "Centenary Celebrations of Indian Cinema Starts on September 21 in Chennai." *Truthdive*. Accessed 20 March 2020. <http://truthdive.com/2013/09/19/centenary-celebrations-of-indian-cinema-starts-on-september-21-in-chennai/>
- Pillai, S. 2019. "Is It Time Tamil Cinema Managed Its Budgets Better?" *The Hindu*, May 8. Accessed 20 March 2020. <https://www.thehindu.com/entertainment/movies/a-look-at-tamil-cinema-budgets/article27065340.ece>
- Poorvaja, S. 2019. "The Rise of the Female Star: Women in Kollywood in the Last Decade." *The Hindu*, December 23. Accessed 10 January 2020. <https://www.thehindu.com/entertainment/movies/the-rise-of-the-female-star-women-in-kollywood-in-the-last-decade/article30377906.ece>
- Pudipeddi, H. 2019. "Kaala, Aramm, Pariyerum Perumal: Dalit-Themed Films Are Getting Mainstream Acceptance in Tamil Cinema." *Firstpost*, January 6. Accessed 20 January 2020. <https://www.firstpost.com/entertainment/kaala-aramm-pariyerum-perumal-dalit-themed-films-are-getting-mainstream-acceptance-in-tamil-cinema-5843831.html>
- Varthan, K. 2018. "Why We Need to Talk About Puliyaigulam Selvaraj, Father of Pariyerum Perumal." Accessed 4 April 2020. <http://orinam.net/selvaraj-father-of-pariyerum-perumal/>
- Velayutham, S. 2008. "Introduction: The Cultural History and Politics of South Indian Tamil Cinema." In *Tamil Cinema: The Cultural Politics of India's Other Film Industry*, edited by Selvaraj Velayutham. London: Routledge.
- Yengde, S. 2018. "Dalit Cinema." *South Asia: Journal of South Asian Studies* 41 (3): 503–518.



Taylor & Francis

Taylor & Francis Group

<http://taylorandfrancis.com>

References

- Bhaskaran, G. 2013. "Mumbai Movies Hog Indian Cinema Centenary Celebrations." *Hindustan Times*, May 17. Accessed 15 February 2020. <https://www.hindustantimes.com/bollywood/mumbai-movies-hog-indian-cinema-centenary-celebrations/story-gNWroysph8JCgceOlglIPN.html>
- Chinniah, S. 2008. "The Tamil Film Heroine: From a Passive Subject to a Pleasurable Object." In *Tamil Cinema: The Cultural Politics of India's Other Film Industry*, edited by Selvaraj Velayutham. New York: Routledge.
- Devaki, V. 2019. "Caste and Tamil Cinema: Now and Then." *Indian Ruminations: Journal of Indian English Writers*, February 5. Accessed 15 February 2020. <https://www.indianruminations.com/contents/articles/caste-and-tamil-cinema-now-and-then-dr-v-devaki-chennai/>
- Hardgrave, R. 1973. "Politics and the Film in Tamilnadu: The Stars and the DMK." *Asian Survey* 13 (3): 288–305.
- The Hindu*. 2017. "Tamil Cinema Portrayed Transgenders in a Bad Light." November 20. Accessed 27 January 2020. <https://www.thehindu.com/news/cities/Madurai/tamil-cinema-portrayedtransgenders-in-a-bad-light/article20559646.ece>
- Jesudoss, P. 2009. "Tamil Cinema." *Communication Research Trends: A Quarterly Review of Communication Research* 28 (4). Accessed 15 February 2020. http://cscc.scu.edu/trends/v28/CRT_v28_n4_Dec2009.pdf
- Kalaroth, N. 2016. "Screen Shifts in Recent Tamil Cinemas: The 'new' New Wave." *Research Scholar: an International Refereed e-Journal of Literary Explorations* 4 (2): 91–97.
- Kapse, A. 2015. "Afterthoughts on the Indian Cinema Centenary." *South Asian Popular Culture* 13 (1): 61–64.
- Krishnakumar, R. 2017. "2017 Was Not the Perfect Year for Feminism in Tamil Cinema, but It Was a Great Beginning." *Scroll.in*, December 30. Accessed 15 February 2020. <https://scroll.in/reel/863130/2017-was-not-the-perfect-year-for-feminism-in-tamil-cinema-but-it-was-a-great-beginning>
- Krishnan, R. 2008. "Imaginary Geographies: The Making of the 'South' in Contemporary Tamil Cinema." In *Tamil Cinema: The Cultural Politics of India's Other Film Industry*, edited by Selvaraj Velayutham. New York: Routledge.
- Lakshmi, C.S. 2008. "A Good Woman, a Very Good Woman: Tamil Cinema's Women." In *Tamil Cinema: The Cultural Politics of India's Other Film Industry*, edited by Selvaraj Velayutham. New York: Routledge.
- Mangayarkkarasi, M. 2019. "Portrayal of Transgender People in Tamil Cinema." *Research Review: International Journal of Multidisciplinary* 4 (2): 669–672.

- NDTV. 2013. "Jayalalithaa Felicitates Tamil Film Legends at Indian Cinema Centenary Fete." *NDTV*, September 22. Accessed 15 February 2020. <https://www.ndtv.com/south/jayalalithaa-felicitates-tamil-film-legends-at-indian-cinema-centenary-fete-535336>
- Pandian, M.S.S. 1992. *The Image Trap: M.G. Ramachandran in Film and Politics*. New Delhi: Newbury Park.
- Patel, R. 2013. "Centenary Celebrations of Indian Cinema Starts on September 21 in Chennai." *Truthdive*. Accessed 20 March 2020. <http://truthdive.com/2013/09/19/centenary-celebrations-of-indian-cinema-starts-on-september-21-in-chennai/>
- Pillai, S. 2019. "Is It Time Tamil Cinema Managed Its Budgets Better?" *The Hindu*, May 8. Accessed 20 March 2020. <https://www.thehindu.com/entertainment/movies/a-look-at-tamil-cinema-budgets/article27065340.ece>
- Poorvaja, S. 2019. "The Rise of the Female Star: Women in Kollywood in the Last Decade." *The Hindu*, December 23. Accessed 10 January 2020. <https://www.thehindu.com/entertainment/movies/the-rise-of-the-female-star-women-in-kollywood-in-the-last-decade/article30377906.ece>
- Pudipeddi, H. 2019. "Kaala, Aramm, Pariyerum Perumal: Dalit-Themed Films Are Getting Mainstream Acceptance in Tamil Cinema." *Firstpost*, January 6. Accessed 20 January 2020. <https://www.firstpost.com/entertainment/kaala-aramm-pariyerum-perumal-dalit-themed-films-are-getting-mainstream-acceptance-in-tamil-cinema-5843831.html>
- Varthan, K. 2018. "Why We Need to Talk About Puliyaugalam Selvaraj, Father of Pariyerum Perumal." Accessed 4 April 2020. <http://orinam.net/selvaraj-father-of-pariyerum-perumal/>
- Velayutham, S. 2008. "Introduction: The Cultural History and Politics of South Indian Tamil Cinema." In *Tamil Cinema: The Cultural Politics of India's Other Film Industry*, edited by Selvaraj Velayutham. London: Routledge.
- Yengde, S. 2018. "Dalit Cinema." *South Asia: Journal of South Asian Studies* 41 (3): 503–518.
- Arabindoo, P. 2008. 'Absent Societies: Contouring Urban Citizenship in Postcolonial Chennai', PhD diss. London School of Economics and Political Science.
- Balshaw, M. and Kennedy, L. 2000. *Urban Space and Representation*. London: Pluto Press.
- Bate, B. 2009. *Tamil Oratory and the Dravidian Aesthetic*. New York: Columbia University Press.
- Bonelli, L. 2001. 'Des quartiers en danger aux "quartiers dangereux"' [From neighbourhoods in danger to 'dangerous neighbourhoods'], *Le Monde Diplomatique* February: 18–19. Available at: <https://www.monde-diplomatique.fr/2001/02/BONELLI/1842> (Accessed 25 August 2020).
- Damodaran, K. 2018. 'Pariyerum Perumal: A Film That Talks Civility in an Uncivil, Casteist Society', *The Wire*, October 12. Available at: <https://thewire.in/film/a-film-that-talks-civility-in-an-uncivil-casteist-society> (Accessed 05 June 2019).
- Damodaran, K. and Gorringer, H. 2017. 'Madurai Formula Films: Caste Pride and Politics in Tamil Cinema', *South Asia Multidisciplinary Academic Journal*. Available at: <http://journals.openedition.org/samaj/4359>
- De Certeau, M. 1984. *The Practice of Everyday Life*. Translated by S. Rendall. Berkeley: University of California Press.
- De Wit, J. 1996. *Poverty, Policy and Politics in Madras Slums: Dynamics of Survival, Gender and Leadership*. Delhi: Sage Publications.
- Dikeç, M. 2007. *Badlands of the Republic: Space, Politics and Urban Policy*. Oxford: Blackwell.

- Foucault, M. 1980. *Power/Knowledge: Selected Interviews and Other Writings, 1972–1977*. Translated and edited by Colin Gordon. New York: Pantheon Books.
- Frøystad, K. 2006. ‘Anonymous Encounters: Class Categorization and Social Distancing in Public Places’, In: Geert De Neve and Henrike Donner (eds.), *The Meaning of the Local: The Urban Neighbourhood in India*. London: Routledge.
- Gorringe, H. 2017. *Panthers in Parliament*. New Delhi: Oxford University Press.
- Harriss, J. 2005. ‘Middle Class Activism and Poor People’s Politics: An Exploration of Civil Society in Chennai’, *London School of Economics Working Paper Series* 05-72. Available at: <https://www.files.ethz.ch/isn/137958/WP72.pdf>
- Harvey, D. 1996. *Justice, Nature and the Geography of Difference*. Oxford: Blackwell.
- Harvey, D. 2008. ‘The Right to the City’, *New Left Review* 53: 23–40.
- Jay, M. 1988. ‘Scopic Regimes of Modernity’, In: Hal Foster (ed.), *Vision and Visuality*. Seattle: Bay Press.
- Kaali, S. 2000. ‘Narrating Seduction: Vicissitudes of the Sexed Subject in Tamil Nativity Film’, In: S. Ravi and Vasudevan (ed.), *Making Meaning in Indian Cinema*. New Delhi: Oxford University Press.
- Karthik, K.N. 2018. ‘Pudhupettai – The Bible for All Vada Chennai Movies’, *Medium*, October 21. Available at: <https://medium.com/@knkarthik1729/pudhupettai-the-bible-for-all-vada-chennai-movies-b87e12210f6d> (Accessed 8 March 2019).
- Khan, Z. 2013. ‘North Chennai Is Still off the Brandwagon’, *The Hindu*, September 2. Available at: <https://www.thehindu.com/news/cities/chennai/north-chennai-is-still-off-the-brandwagon/article5083125.ece> (Accessed 12 February 2019).
- Krishnan, R. 2008. ‘Imaginary Geographies: The makings of “South” in Contemporary Tamil cinema’, In: S. Velayutham (ed.), *Tamil Cinema: The Cultural Politics of India’s Other Film Industry*. Abingdon: Routledge, 139–153.
- Kuttaiah, P. 2018. ‘How Pa Ranjith’s Kaala Changes the Way We Imagine the City’, *The Caravan Magazine*, June 24. Available at: <https://caravanmagazine.in/film-television/pa-ranjith-kaala-changes-imagine-city> (Accessed 09 March 2019).
- Lefebvre, H. 1996. *Writings on Cities*. Oxford: Blackwell.
- Madras. 2014. Dir. Pa. Ranjith. Studio Green.
- Mathevan, S. 2018. ‘Vada Chennai Brings about Another north-south Divide’, *News Today*, October 19. Available at: <https://newstodaynet.com/index.php/2018/10/19/vada-chennai-brings-about-another-north-south-divide/> (Accessed 16 March 2019).
- Mines, M. 2006. ‘Temples and Charity’, In: Geert De Neve and Henrike Donner (eds.), *The Meaning of the Local: The Urban Neighbourhood in India*. London: Routledge.
- Mitchell, D. 2003. *The Right to the City: Social Justice and the Fight for Public Space*. New York: The Guilford Press.
- Muthunayagam, L. 2018. ‘Idhudhan Ungalukku Therindha Vada Chennaiya? Vyasarpadi Ilaiginarin Manakkumural’ [Is this the only North Chennai you know? A Vyasarpadi youth’s lament], *The Hindu Tamil*, October 29.
- Nield, S. 1979. ‘Colonial Urbanism: The Development of Madras City in the Eighteenth and Nineteenth Centuries’, *Modern Asian Studies* 13(2): 217–246.
- Peter, P. 2013. ‘“Madras” Crime Gangs: Low in Number, High on Terror’, *The Hindu*, August 23. Available at: <http://www.thehindu.com/news/cities/chennai/madras-crime-gangs-low-in-number-high-on-terror/article5049711.ece> (Accessed 19 February 2019).
- Philip, M. 2016. ‘Slums in Chennai Increase by 50% in a Single Decade’, *The Times of India*, January 18. Available at: http://timesofindia.indiatimes.com/articleshow/50618951.cms?utm_source=contentofinterest&utm_medium=text&utm_campaign=cppst (Accessed 05 May 2019).

20 References

- Pillai, S. 2002. 'Age of Rage', *The Hindu Friday Review*, May 31. Available at: <http://www.hindu.com/thehindu/fr/2002/05/31/stories/2002053100910200.htm> (Accessed 20 February 2019).
- Ramakrishnan, V. 2004. *Chennai Gaana*. Chennai: Marutha Publications.
- Raman, G. 2018. 'More Madras than Chennai': What Draws Tamil Filmmakers to the North of the City', *The Scroll*, October 20. Available at: <https://scroll.in/reel/889119/more-madras-than-chennai-what-draws-tamil-filmmakers-to-the-north-of-the-city> (Accessed 26 February 2019).
- Roberts, N. 2016. *To Be Cared for: The Power of Conversion and Foreignness of Belonging in an Indian Slum*. Berkeley: University of California Press.
- Saharan, T., Pfeffer, K. and Baud, I. 2017. 'Urban Livelihoods in Slums of Chennai: Developing a Relational Understanding', *The European Journal of Development Research* 30(2): 276–296.
- Selby, M. A. and Viswanathan Peterson, I. 2008. 'Introduction', In: Martha Ann Selby and Indira Viswanathan Peterson (eds.), *Tamil Geographies: Cultural Constructions of Space and Place in South India*. New York: State University of New York Press.
- Srinivasaraju, S. 2007. 'Schizoid Cityscapes', *Outlook* July 16. Available at: <https://www.outlookindia.com/magazine/story/schizoid-cityscapes/235099> (Accessed 09 May 2019).
- Sripathi, A. 2017. 'Tamil Films: How North Chennai Marks Its Presence While Kodambakkam Thrives', *Hindustan Times*, February 23. Available at: <https://www.hindustantimes.com/regional-movies/tamil-films-how-north-chennai-marks-its-present-while-kodambakkam-thrives/story-TrsZN4P2BCWrlz61aOOBsK.html> (Accessed 12 May 2019).
- Vada Chennai*. 2018. Dir. Vetrimaaran. Wunderbar Films.
- Vasudevan, N. 2017. 'Between Ooru, Area, and Pettai: The Terms of the Local in Tamil Cinema of the Twenty-First Century', *Positions* 25(1): 145–172.
- Velayutham, S. 2008. 'Introduction: The Cultural History and Politics of South Indian Tamil Cinema', In: Selvaraj Velayutham (ed.), *Tamil Cinema: The Cultural Politics of India's Other Film Industry*. Oxford: Routledge.
- Viji, G. M. 2009. *Naan Santhitha Maranagal* [The Deaths I Have Faced]. Chennai: Karuppu Pirathigal.
- Vithayathil, T. and Singh, G. 2012. 'Spaces of Discrimination: Residential Segregation in Indian Cities', *Economic and Political Weekly* 47(37): 60–66.
- Wacquant, L. 2007. 'Territorial Stigmatization in the Age of Advanced Marginality', *Thesis Eleven* 91(1): 66–77.
- Yengde, S. 2018. 'Dalit Cinema', *South Asia: Journal of South Asian Studies* 41(3): 503–518.
- Anand, S. 2005. 'Politics, Tamil Cinema *Eshtyle*.' *Outlook India*, 30 May.
- Ansari, M.T., ed. 2001. *Secularism, Islam and Modernity: Selected Essays of Alam Khudmuri*. New Delhi: Sage.
- Asad, Talal. 1992. 'Conscripts of Western Civilization?' In: C. Gailey Griner (ed.), *Dialectical Anthropology: Essays in Honour of Stanley Diamond. Vol. 1*. Gainesville, Florida: University Press of Florida.
- Baskaran, S. Theodore. 2009. *History Through the Lens: Perspectives on South Indian Cinema*. Hyderabad: Orient Blackswan.
- Chakravarthy, Venkatesh, and M.S.S. Pandian. 1994. 'More on "Roja".' *Economic and Political Weekly* 29(11): 642–644.

- Chakravarthy, Venkatesh. 2010. 'David Leanin Ryan's Daughterum (1970) Manvaasanai Cinimavin Vaniga Vadivamum.' [David Lean's *Ryan's Daughter* (1970) and the Economic Structure of Nativity Cinema] *Kaatchi Pizhai* 1: 12–21.
- Chandran, Tha. 2010. 'Kaadhalum Kadhal Sarndha Nilamum.' [Love and Land in *Kadhal*]. *Thirai Vimarsanam*, November 10. <http://www.keetru.com/index.php/2018-01-12-06-00-39/2014-03-08-04-36-23/2014-03-14-11-17-58/10900-2010-09-05-08-15-20> (Accessed 1 March 2020).
- Damodaran, Karthikeyan, and Hugo Gorringer. 2017. 'Madurai Formula Films: Caste Pride and Politics in Tamil Cinema.' *South Asia Multidisciplinary Academic Journal*, June 22. <https://journals.openedition.org/samaj/4359#quotation> (Accessed 24 August 2019).
- Devasundaram, Ashwin Immanuel, ed. 2018. *Indian Cinema Beyond Bollywood: The New Independent Cinema Revolution*. New York: Routledge.
- Devadas, Vijay, and Selvaraj Velayutham. 2008. 'Encounters with "India": (Ethno-)Nationalism in Tamil Cinema.' In: Selvaraj Velayutham (ed.), *Tamil Cinema: The Cultural Politics of India's Other Film Industry*. London & New York: Routledge.
- Dhareshwar, Vivek. 1993. 'Caste and the Secular Self.' *Journal of Arts and Ideas* 25(26): 119–126.
- Dhareshwar, Vivek, and R. Srivatsan. 1996. "'Rowdy-Sheeters": An Essay on Subalternity and Politics.' In: Shahid Amin and Dipesh Chakrabarty (eds.), *Subaltern Studies IX*. New Delhi: Oxford University Press.
- Diamond, Stanley. 1974. *In Search of the Primitive: A Critique of Civilization*. New Brunswick, NJ: Transaction Books.
- 'Exclusive: Bala on *Naan Kadavul*, God and Faith.' 2009. <http://specials.rediff.com/movies/2009/mar/10slde1-bala-on-naan-kadavul-god-and-faith.html>. (Accessed 7 January 2019).
- Foucault, Michel, and Jay MisKowiec. 1986. 'Of Other Spaces.' *Diacritics* 16(1): 22–27.
- Hardgrave, Robert L., and Stanley A. Kochanek, eds. 2008. *India: Government and Politics in a Developing Nation*. Boston: Thomson Wadsworth.
- Hariharan, K. 2011. 'Getting on the Virtual Bridge.' *The Hindu (Sunday Magazine)*: 2.
- Kaali, Sundar. 2000. 'Narrating Seduction: Vicissitudes of the Sexed Subject in Tamil Nativity Film.' In: Ravi Vasudevan (ed.), *Making Meaning in Indian Cinema*. New Delhi: Oxford University Press, 168–190.
- Kadhal*. 2004. Dir. Balaji Sakthivel. S Pictures.
- Krishnan, Rajan. 2008. 'Imaginary Geographies: The Makings of "South" in Contemporary Tamil Cinema.' In: Selvaraj Velayutham (ed.), *Tamil Cinema: The Cultural Politics of India's Other Film Industry*. Oxon: Routledge.
- Krishnan, Rajan. 2010. 'Kathanayaganin Maranam [Death of the Hero].' *Katchipizhai* 1: 7–11.
- Leonard, Dickens. 2015. 'Spectacle Spaces: Production of Caste in Recent Tamil Films.' *South Asian Popular Culture* 13(2): 155–173.
- Maderya, Kumuthan. 2010. 'Rage against the State: Historicizing the "Angry Young Man" in Tamil Cinema.' *Jump Cut* 52: 1–6.
- Niranjana, Tejaswini. 1994a. 'Whose Nation? Tourists and Terrorists in "Roja".' *Economic and Political Weekly* 24(3): 79–82.
- Niranjana, Tejaswini. 1994b. 'Roja Revisited.' *Economic and Political Weekly* 29(21): 1299.
- Pandian, M.S.S. 1989. 'Culture and Subaltern Consciousness: An Aspect of MGR Phenomenon.' *Economic and Political Weekly* 24(30): 62–68.

- Pandian, M.S.S. 1992. *The Image Trap: M.G. Ramachandran in Film and Politics*. New Delhi: Sage.
- Pandian, M.S.S. 2005. 'Parasakthi: Life and Times of a DMK Film.' In: Ravi Vasudevan (ed.), *Making Meaning in Indian Cinema*. New Delhi: Oxford University Press.
- Pandian, M.S.S., and Rajan Krishnan. 2006. 'The Brahmin and the Citizen: Shankar's *Anniyan*.' *Economic and Political Weekly* 30(30): 3055–3060.
- Paruthiveeran. 2007. Dir. Ameer Sultan. Studio Green.
- Prasad, M. Madhava. 2004. 'Reigning Stars: The Political Career of South Indian Cinema.' In: Lucy Fischer and Marcia Landy (eds.), *Stars: The Film Reader*. London: Routledge.
- Rajadhyaksha, Ashish. 2008. 'The "Bollywoodization" of Indian Cinema: Cultural Nationalism in a Global Arena.' In: Aswin Punathambekar and Anadam P. Kavoori (eds.), *Global Bollywood*. New Delhi: Oxford University Press.
- Rajadhyaksha, Ashish. 2009. *Indian Cinema in the Time of Celluloid: From Bollywood to the Emergency*. New Delhi: Tulika.
- Scott, David. 2004. *Conscripts of Modernity: The Tragedy of Colonial Engagement*. Durham: Duke University Press.
- Sebastian, Pradeep. 2008. 'Beyond Old Kollywood.' *The Hindu*, January 13. Available at: <http://www.thehindu.com/todays-paper/tp-features/tp-sundaymagazine/beyond-old-kollywood/article1436927.ece> (Accessed 23 February 2019).
- Shrirasa. 2010. 'Maduraiyai Mayyamitta Thirai Padangal' [Movies based on Madurai]. *Thirai Seidhigal*, October 28. Available at: <http://www.keetru.com/index.php/2018-01-12-06-00-39/2014-03-08-04-36-23/2014-03-14-11-17-57/11160-2010-10-27-21-27-14> (Accessed 1 March 2019).
- Subramaniapuram. 2008. Dir. Sasikumar. Company Productions.
- Stallybrass, Peter. 1990. 'Marx and Heterogeneity: Thinking the Lumpenproletariat.' *Representations* 31: 65–94.
- Vasudevan, Ravi, ed. 2000. *Making Meaning in Indian Cinema*. New Delhi: Oxford University Press.
- Veyil. 2006. Dir. Vasanthabalan. S Pictures.
- Bathran, R. 2016. 'The Many Omissions of a Concept: Discrimination amongst Scheduled Castes.' *Economic and Political Weekly* 51(47): 30–34.
- Chatterjee, P. 1994. 'Caste and Subaltern Consciousness.' In: Ranajit Guha (ed.), *Subaltern Studies VI: Writings on South Asian History and Society*. New Delhi: OUP.
- Chidambaranar, S. 2016. *Periyar: Vaazhkai Varalaru*. Chennai: Neer Veliyeedu.
- Fraser, N. 2008. *Social Justice in the Age of Identity Politics: Redistribution, Recognition & Participation*. New Delhi: Critical Quest.
- Geetha, V. and S.V. Rajadurai 1993. 'Dalits and Non-Brahmin Consciousness in Colonial Tamil Nadu.' *Economic and Political Weekly* 28(39): 2091–2098.
- Gorringe, H. 2007. 'Taming the Dalit Panthers: Dalit Politics in Tamil Nadu.' *Journal of South Asian Development* 2(1): 51–73.
- Gorringe, H. 2017. *Panthers in Parliament: Dalits, Caste and Political Power in South India*. New Delhi: Oxford University Press.
- Krishnan, R. and R. Sriramachandran 2018. 'Dravidian Futures.' *Seminar* 708: 62–68.
- Manoharan, K.R. 2016. 'The Missing Periyar and the Curious Tamil Nationalism of Kabali.' *Economic and Political Weekly*, August 13. Available at: <https://www.epw.in/journal/2016/33/web-exclusives/missing-periyar-and-curious-tamil-nationalism-kabali.html> (Accessed 25 January 2019).

- Manoharan, K.R. 2017. 'Anti-Casteist Casteism? A Fanonist Critique of Ramasamy's Discourse on Caste.' *Interventions: The International Journal of Postcolonial Studies* 19(1): 73–90.
- Manoharan, K.R. 2019. *Frantz Fanon: Identity and Resistance*. Hyderabad: Orient BlackSwan.
- Manoharan, K.R. 2020. 'In the Path of Ambedkar: Periyar and the Dalit Question.' *South Asian History and Culture*. doi:10.1080/19472498.2020.1755127.
- News 18 Tamil Nadu. 2016. 'Is Kabali a Dalit Movie? – An Interview with Kabali Director Pa. Ranjith'. *YouTube*, July 26. Available at: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=FCU4zmHiWeg> (Accessed 8 June 2019).
- Pandian, M.S.S. 2007. *Brahmin and Non-Brahmin: Genealogies of the Tamil Political Present*. Ranikhet: Permanent Black.
- Pandian, M.S.S. 2015. *The Image Trap: M.G. Ramachandran in Film and Politics*. 2nd ed. New Delhi: Sage.
- Pillai, S.E. 2015. *Madras Studios: Narrative, Genre and Ideology in Tamil Cinema*. New Delhi: Sage.
- Rajamani, R. 2018. 'The Dharavi story in Tamil cinema: How "Kaala" Inverts the "Nayakan" Gaze.' *The News Minute*, August 30. Available at: <https://www.thenewsminute.com/article/dharavi-story-tamil-cinema-how-kaala-inverts-nayakan-gaze-87512> (Accessed 15 May 2019).
- Rajangam, S. 2018. 'Pa Ranjith's "Kaala" Turns the Ramayana on its Head – By Making Raavana the Hero.' *Scroll*, June 14. Available at: <https://scroll.in/reel/882609/pa-ranjiths-kaala-turns-the-ramayana-on-its-head-by-making-raavana-the-hero> (Accessed 10 April 2019).
- Ranjith, P. 2018. 'View: The Problem Is the Brahminical System, the Basis of Which Is Inequality.' *The Economic Times*, November 24. Available at: <https://economictimes.indiatimes.com/news/politics-and-nation/view-the-problem-is-the-brahminical-system-the-basis-of-which-is-inequality/articleshow/66787222.cms> (Accessed 19 April 2019).
- Richman, P. 1995. 'Epic and State: Contesting Interpretations of the Ramayana.' *Public Culture* 7(3): 631–654.
- Sriramachandran, R. 2018. 'Pluralization of Political Identity.' *Seminar* 708: 49–52.
- Velayutham, S. 2008. 'The Diaspora and the Global Circulation of Tamil Cinema.' In: Selvaraj Velayutham (ed.), *Tamil Cinema: The Cultural Politics of India's Other Film Industry*. London & New York: Routledge.
- Venkatachalapathy, A.R. 2018. *Tamil Characters: Personalities, Politics, Culture*. New Delhi: Pan.
- Zizek, S. 2014. *Trouble in Paradise: From the End of History to the End of Capitalism*. London: Allen Lane.
- Zvelebil, K. 1988. 'R va a the Great in Modern Tamil Fiction.' *Journal of the Royal Asiatic Society of Great Britain and Ireland* 120: 126–136.
- Butler, Judith. (1990) 2005. *Trouble dans le genre: Le féminisme et la subversion de l'identité* (Gender Trouble, Feminism and the Subversion of Identity). Paris: La Découverte.
- Chinniah, Sathiavathi. 2008. 'The Tamil film Heroine. From a Passive Subject to a Pleasurable object'. In: Selvaraj Velayutham (ed.), *Tamil Cinema: The Cultural Politics of India's Other Film Industry*, 29–43. London: Routledge.

- Cinema and Society, Shaping Our Worldview Beyond the Lens. Investigation on the Impact of Gender Representation in Indian Films*. 2016. Los Angeles: Geena Davis Institute for Gender in Media.
- Dubois, Régis. 2013. 'Boxe et cinéma'. *Le sens des images* (online magazine), novembre 1st. Available at: <http://lesensdesimages.com/2013/11/01/boxe-et-cinema-combats-ideologiques/> (Accessed 28 December 2018).
- Grindon, Leger. 2007. 'The boxing film and genre theory', *Quarterly Review of Film & Video*, 24(5), 403–410. doi:10.1080/10509200500536066.
- Lakshmi, C. S. 2008. 'A good woman, a very good woman. Tamil cinema's women'. In: Selvaraj Velayutham (ed.), *Tamil Cinema. The Cultural Politics of India's Other Film Industry*, 16–28. London: Routledge.
- Lindner, Katarina. 2014. 'Gender trouble in female sports films'. In: Eric Anderson and Jennifer Hargreaves (eds.), *Routledge Handbook of Sport, Gender and Sexuality*. London: Routledge.
- Maderya, Kumuthan. 2010. 'Rage against the state: Historicizing the "angry young man" in Tamil cinema', *Jump Cut, a Review of Contemporary Media* (online magazine). <https://www.ejumpcut.org/archive/jc52.2010/Tamil/index.html> (Accessed 30 December 2018).
- Mulvey, Laura. (1975) 2017. 'Plaisir visuel et cinema narratif' ('Visual pleasure and narrative cinema'). In Teresa Castro (ed.), *Au delà du plaisir visuel. Féminisme, énigmes, cinéphilie*, 33–51. Paris: Editions Mimesis.
- Natarajan, Tamil Selvi. 2018. 'Fitmus test analysis on women centric Tamil films by women filmmakers', *Research Review International Journals of Multidisciplinary*, 3(1), 105–109, January. Available at: https://www.academia.edu/37037408/Fitmus_Test_Analysis_of_Women_Centric_Tamil_Films_by_Women_Filmmakers (Accessed 30 December 2018).
- Pillai, Sreedhar. 2019. 'Aadai to Kolaiyuthir Kaalam: A look at upcoming Women-centric films in Tamil', *The Hindu*, July 10.
- Sengupta, Somini. 2009. 'In India, women see boxing as a way up', *The New York Times*, August 25.
- Srinivas, Lakshmi. 2002. 'The active audience: Spectatorship, social relations and the experience of cinema in India', *Media, Culture & Society*. 24, 155–173. London: Sage Publications.
- Trimbur, Lucia. 2011. 'Tough love: Mediation and articulation in the urban boxing gym', *Ethnography*. 12, 334–335. London: Sage Publications.
- Woodward, Kath. 2008. *Boxing, Masculinity and Identity: The "I" of the Tiger*. London: Routledge.
- Adorno, Theodor. 1997. *Aesthetic Theory*. Trans. Robert Hullot-Kentor. Minneapolis: U of Minnesota Press.
- Baas, Michiel. 2016. 'The Neoliberal Masculine Logic: Skilled Migration, International Students, and the Indian "Other" in Australia'. In: Garth Stahl, Joseph Derick Nelson and Derren O. Wallace (eds.), *Masculinity and Aspiration in the Era of Neoliberal Education: International Perspectives Vol. 3*. New York: Routledge.
- Baas, Michiel. 2018. 'The New Indian Male'. In: Knut Jacobsen (ed.), *Routledge Handbook of Contemporary India*. London & New York: Routledge.
- Clarke, J., et al. 2007. *Creating Citizen-Consumers: Changing Publics and Changing Public Services*. London: SAGE.
- Connell, R. W. 1995. *Masculinities*. Cambridge: Polity Press.

- DeAngelis, Michael. 2014. *Reading the Bromance: Homosocial Relationships in Film and Television*. Detroit, MI: Wayne State University Press.
- Deckha, Nitin. 2007. 'From Artist-as-Hero to the Creative Young Man: Bollywood and the Aestheticization of Indian Masculinity'. In: Gurbir Jolly, Zenia Wadhvani and Deborah Barretto (eds.), *Once Upon a Time in Bollywood: The Global Swing in Hindi Cinema*. Toronto: TSAR Publications.
- Foucault, Michel. 2010 *The Birth of Biopolitics: Lectures at the Collège de France 1978–1979*, trans. G. Burchell. Basingstoke: Palgrave MacMillan.
- Ghosh, Arun. 1995. 'Who's Afraid of Liberalisation?' *Economic and Political Weekly* 30(1): 12–14. <https://www.jstor.org/stable/4402220?seq=1>
- Goopu, Nandini. 2013. *Enterprise Culture in Neoliberal India: Studies in Youth, Class, Work and Media*. Vol. 74. Abingdon, Oxon: Routledge.
- Harvey, David. 2005. *A Brief History of Neoliberalism*. Oxford: Oxford University Press.
- Hebbur, Nandini. 2017. 'Engineering Respectability: The Politics of Aspiration in an Engineering College'. *Subversions: A Journal of Emerging Research in Media and Cultural Studies*. Vol. 5. <http://subversions.tiss.edu/vol-5/nandini/>
- Hebbur, Nandini. 2018. 'Subjectivities of Suitability: 'Intimate Aspirations' in an Engineering College'. *South Asia Multidisciplinary Academic Journal* 19(19): 1–18. doi:10.4000/samaj.4578.
- Hill, Dave. 2010. 'Class, Capital, and Education in This Neoliberal and Neoconservative Period'. In: Dave Hill, Peter McLaren and Sheila Macrine (eds.), *Revolutionizing Pedagogy: Education for Social Justice within and beyond Global Neoliberalism*. New York: Palgrave Macmillan.
- Huber, E. and F. Solt. 2004. 'Successes and Failures of Neoliberalism'. *Latin American Research Review* 39(3): 150–164.
- Kaali, Sundar. 2000. 'Narrating Seduction: Vicissitudes of the Sexed Subject in Tamil Nativity Film'. In: Ravi Vasudevan (ed.), *Making Meaning in Indian Cinema*. New Delhi: Oxford UP.
- Mirowski, Philip. 2013. *Never Let a Serious Crisis Go to Waste: How Neoliberalism Survived the Financial Meltdown*. London: Verso Books.
- Nakassis, Constantine V. 2016. *Doing Style: Youth and Mass Mediation in South India*. London: University of Chicago Press.
- Nakassis, Constantine V. and Melanie A. Dean. 2007. 'Desire, Youth, and Realism in Tamil Cinema'. *Journal of Linguistic Anthropology* 17(1): 77–104. doi:10.1525/jlin.2007.17.1.77.
- Rajamani, Imke. 2017. 'Feeling Anger, Compassion and Community in Popular Telugu Cinema'. *The Indian Economic and Social History Review* 54(1): 103–122. doi:10.1177%2F0019464616683482.
- Srinivas, S. V. 2009. *Megastar: Chiranjeevi and Telugu Cinema After N. T. Rama Rao*. Oxford & New Delhi: Oxford University Press.
- Subramanian, Ajantha. 2015. 'Making Merit: The Indian Institutes of Technology and the Social Life of Caste'. *Comparative Studies in Society and History* 57(2): 291–322. doi:10.1017/S0010417515000043.
- Tyler, Imogen. 2013. *Revolting Subjects: Social Abjection and Resistance in Neoliberal Britain*. London & New York: Zed Books.
- Ahmed, S. 2007. 'A Phenomenology of Whiteness.' *Feminist Theory* 8(2): 149–168. doi:10.1177/1464700107078139.
- Baskaran, S. Theodore. 1981. *The Message Bearers: The Nationalistic Politics and the Entertainment Media in South India 1880–1945*. Madras: Cre-A.

- Bharathi, K. 2013. *Tamil Cinemavil Pengal (Tamil)*. Chennai: Vikatan Publication.
- Chinniah, Sathiyavathi. 2008. 'The Tamil Film Heroine: From a Passive Subject to a Pleasurable Object.' In: Selvaraj Velayutham (ed.), *Tamil Cinema: The Cultural Politics of India's Other Film Industry*. New York: Routledge.
- Dickey, Sara. 2001. 'Opposing Faces: Film Star Fan Clubs and the Construction of Class Identities in South India.' In: Rachel Dwyer and Christopher Pinney (eds.), *Pleasure and the Nation*. New Delhi: Oxford University Press.
- Dickey, Sara. 2008. 'The Nurturing Hero: Changing Images of MGR.' In: Selvaraj Velayutham (ed.), *Tamil Cinema: The Cultural Politics of India's Other Film Industry*. New York: Routledge.
- Dutt, P. 2015, April 16. 'Most Desirable Woman 2014: Amy Jackson.' *Times of India*. Chennai. Available at: <http://timesofindia.indiatimes.com/entertainment/tamil/movies/news/Chennai-Times-Most-Desirable-Woman-2014-Amy-Jackson/articleshow/46928377.cms> (Accessed 26 March 2019).
- Hardgrave Jr., Robert L. 1975. 'When Stars Displace the Gods: The Folk Culture of Cinema in Tamil Nadu.' *Occasional Paper Series* 2: 1–25.
- Hardgrave Jr., Robert L. 2008. 'Politics and the Film in Tamil Nadu: The Stars and the DMK.' In: Selvaraj Velayutham (ed.), *Tamil Cinema: The Cultural Politics of India's Other Film Industry*. New York: Routledge.
- Jha, Priya. 2003. 'Lyrical Nationalism: Gender, Friendship, and Excess in 1970s Hindi Cinema.' *The Velvet Light Trap* 51(1): 43–53. doi:10.1353/vlt.2003.0007.
- Lakshmi, C. S. 2008. 'A Good Woman, a Very Good Woman: Tamil Cinema's Women'. In: Selvaraj Velayutham (ed.), *Tamil Cinema: The Cultural Politics of India's Other Film Industry*. New York: Routledge.
- Mishra, Samina. 1999. 'Dish Is Life: Cable Operators and the Neighborhood.' In: Christiane Brosius and Melissa Butcher (ed.), *Image Journeys: Audio-Visual Media and Cultural Change in India*. New Delhi: Sage.
- Mishra, Vijay. 1985. 'Towards a Theoretical Critique of Indian Cinema.' *Screen* 26(3–4): 133–145.
- Mulvey, Laura. 1975. 'Visual Pleasure and Narrative Cinema.' *Screen* 16(3): 6–18. doi:10.1007/978-1-349-19798-9_3.
- Nakassis, Constantine V, and Melanie a Dean. 2007. 'Desire, Youth, and Realism in Tamil Cinema.' *Journal of Linguistic Anthropology* 17(1): 77–104. doi:10.1525/jlin.2007.17.1.77.77.
- Nakassis, Constantine V. 2015. 'A Tamil-Speaking Heroine.' *BioScope: South Asian Screen Studies* 6(2): 165–186. doi:10.1177/0974927615600625.
- Narayanan, Aranthai. 2008. *Thamizh Cinemavin Kathai*. 3rd edition. Chennai: New Century Book House (Pty) Ltd.
- Osuri, Goldie. 2008. 'Ashcoloured Whiteness: The Transfiguration of Aishwarya Rai.' *South Asian Popular Culture* 6(2): 109–123. doi:10.1080/14746680802365212.
- Adams, Terri M., and Douglas B. Fuller. 2016. "The Words Have Changed But the Ideology Remains the Same: Misogynistic Lyrics in Rap Music." *Journal of Black Studies* 36 (6): 938–957. doi:10.1177/0021934704274072.
- Balaji, Murali. 2014. "Indian Masculinity." *Technoculture* 4: 1–12.
- Baskaran, S. Theodore. 1991. "Music for the Masses: Film Songs of Tamil Nadu." *Economic and Political Weekly* 26 (11/12): 755–758.
- Chatterjee, Tupur. 2019. "Rape Culture, Misogyny, and Urban Anxiety in NH10 and Pink." *Feminist Media Studies* 19 (1): 130–146. doi:10.1080/14680777.2017.1369446.

- Chinniah, Sathivathi. 2008. "The Tamil Film Heroine: From a Passive Subject to a Pleasurable Object." In *Tamil Cinema: The Cultural Politics of India's Other Film Industry*, edited by Salvaraj Velayutham. London: Routledge.
- Corprew, Charles S., Jamaal S. Matthews, and Mitchell Avery DeVell. 2014. "Men at the Crossroads: A Profile Analysis of Hypermasculinity in Emerging Adulthood." *The Journal of Men's Studies* 22 (2): 105–121. doi:10.3149/jms.2202.105.
- Datta, Sangeeta. 2000. "Globalisation and Representations of Women in Indian Cinema." *Social Scientist* 28 (3/4): 71–82.
- Getter, Joseph, and B. Balasubrahmaniyan. 2008. "Tamil Film Music: Sound and Significance." In *Global Soundtracks: Worlds of Film Music*, edited by Mark Slobin. Middletown: Wesleyan University Press.
- Jackson, Joe. 2011. "Nonsensical, Semi-English Music Video Goes Viral in India: The Song's Lyrics Are Practically Gibberish, but India Can't Stop Listening." *Time*, November 30. Accessed 1 March 2020. <https://newsfeed.time.com/2011/11/30/non-sensical-semi-english-music-video-goes-viral-in-india/>
- Jain, Parul, Enakshi Roy, Nisha Garud, and Imran Mazid. 2019. "Sexuality and Substance Abuse Portrayals in Item Songs in Bollywood Movies." *South Asian Popular Culture* 17 (1): 15–29. doi:10.1080/14746689.2019.1585605.
- Kaali, Sundar. 2000. "Narrating Seduction: Vicissitudes of the Sexed Subject in Tamil Nativity Film." In *Making Meaning in Indian Cinema*, edited by Ravi S. Vasudevan. New Delhi: Oxford University Press.
- Kahn-Harris, Keith. 2003. "The Aesthetics of Hate Music." Accessed 21 December 2018. <http://archive.jpr.org.uk/download?id=2235>
- Karupiah, Premalatha. 2015. "Have Beauty Ideals Evolved? Reading of Beauty Ideals in Tamil Movies by Malaysian Indian Youths." *Sociological Inquiry* 85 (2): 239–261. doi:10.1111/soin.12070.
- Karupiah, Premalatha. 2016. "Hegemonic Femininity in Tamil Movies: Exploring the Voices of Youths in Chennai, India." *Continuum* 30 (1): 114–125. doi:10.1080/10304312.2015.1117574.
- Karupiah, Premalatha. 2017. "Voiceless Heroines: Use of Dubbed Voices in Tamil Movies." *Asian Women* 33 (1): 73–98.
- Lillian, Donna L. 2007. "A Thorn by Any Other Name: Sexist Discourse as Hate Speech." *Discourse and Society* 18 (6): 719–740. doi:10.1177/0957926507082193.
- Manne, Kate. 2017. *Down Girl: The Logic of Misogyny*. Oxford: Oxford University Press.
- Messner, Beth A., Art Jipson, Paul J. Becker, and Bryan Byers. 2007. "The Hardest Hate: A Sociological Analysis of Country Hate Music." *Popular Music and Society* 30 (4): 513–531. doi:10.1080/03007760701546380.
- Mishra, Neha. 2015. "India and Colorism: The Finer Nuances." *Washington University Global Studies Law Review* 14: 725–750.
- Nadeem, Shehzad. 2014. "Fair and Anxious: On Mimicry and Skin-Lightening in India." *Social Identities* 20 (2–3): 224–238.
- Nakassis, Constantine V. 2010. "Youth and Status in Tamil Nadu, India." PhD., University of Pennsylvania.
- Nakassis, Constantine V. 2015. "A Tamil-Speaking Heroine." *BioScope: South Asian Screen Studies* 6 (2): 165–186.
- Nielsen, Laura Beth. 2002. "Subtle, Pervasive, Harmful: Racist and Sexist Remarks in Public as Hate Speech." *Journal of Social Issues* 58 (2): 265–280.
- Richardson-Self, Louise. 2018. "Woman-Hating: On Misogyny, Sexism, and Hate Speech." *Hypatia* 33 (2): 256–272.

- Rogers, Martyn. 2009. "Between Fantasy and 'Reality': Tamil Film Star Fan Club Networks and the Political Economy of Film Fandom." *South Asia: Journal of South Asian Studies* 32 (1): 63–85. doi:10.1080/00856400802709284.
- Srivatsan. 2016. "Sivakarthikeyan's Remo to Dhanush's Kolaveri Di: When Will Tamil Cinema Bid Goodbye to Misogyny?" *India Today*, October 12. Accessed 28 January 2020. <https://www.indiatoday.in/movies/standpoint/story/remo-review-sivakarthikeyan-dhanush-kolaveri-di-simbu-beep-song-346113-2016-10-12>
- Stevenson, Ana. 2013. "Making Gender Divisive: 'Post-Feminism', Sexism and Media Representations of Julia Gillard." *Burgmann Journal* 1 (2): 53–63.
- Surendhar, M.K. 2018. "Andrea Jeremiah on Lack of Strong Female Characters in Tamil Cinema: 'It's a Completely Male-Dominated Industry'." March 13. Accessed 31 May 2019. <https://www.firstpost.com/entertainment/andrea-jeremiah-on-lack-of-strong-female-characters-in-tamil-cinema-its-a-completely-male-dominated-industry-4387983.html>
- Surendran, Saumya, and Sudha Venkataswamy. 2017. "'Machi Open the Bottle!' Glorification of Alcohol and Stalking in Tamil Film Songs." 4th International Conference on Literature, History, Humanities and Social Sciences (LHHSS-2017) Singapore, August 8–9.
- Vandenbosch, Laura, and Steven Eggermont. 2012. "Understanding Sexual Objectification: A Comprehensive Approach Toward Media Exposure and Girls' Internalization of Beauty Ideals, Self-Objectification, and Body Surveillance." *Journal of Communication* 62 (5): 869–887. doi:10.1111/j.1460-2466.2012.01667.x.
- Vokey, Megan, Bruce Tefft, and Chris Tysiaczny. 2013. "An Analysis of Hyper-Masculinity in Magazine Advertisements." *Sex Roles* 68 (9–10): 562–576.
- Warner, William, and Julia Hirschberg. 2012. "Detecting Hate Speech on the World Wide Web." Workshop on Language in Social Media, Montreal.
- Weitzer, Ronald, and Charis E. Kubrin. 2009. "Misogyny in Rap Music: A Content Analysis of Prevalence and Meanings." *Men and Masculinities* 12 (1): 3–29.
- Allocco, Amy L. 2009. "Snakes, Goddesses, and Anthills: Modern Challenges and Women's Ritual Responses in Contemporary South India." PhD diss., Emory University.
- Bhrugubanda, Uma Maheswari. 2014. "Devotion and Horror in a Women's Genre: Exploring Subalternity in Cinema." *Critical Quarterly* 56 (3): 21–33. doi:10.1111/crqi.12135.
- Chatterjee, Partha. 1993. *The Nation and Its Fragments: Colonial and Postcolonial Histories*. Princeton: Princeton University Press.
- Dickey, Sara. 1993. *Cinema and the Urban Poor in South India*. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press.
- Dickey, Sara. 2002. "Anjali's Prospects: Class Mobility in Urban India." In *Everyday Life in South Asia*, edited by Diane P. Mines and Sarah Lamb. Bloomington: Indiana University Press.
- Dickey, Sara. 2016. *Living Class in Urban India*. New Jersey: Rutgers University Press.
- Dwyer, Rachel. 2011. "Zara hatke ('Somewhat Different'): The New Middle Classes and the Changing Forms of Hindi Cinema." In *Being Middle-Class in India: A Way of Life*, edited by Henrike Donner. London: Routledge.
- Fernandes, Leela. 2006. *India's New Middle Class: Democratic Politics in an Era of Economic Reform*. Minneapolis: University of Minnesota Press.
- Gaston, Anne-Marie. 2010. "Dance and the Hindu Woman: Bharatanatyam Re-Ritualized." In *Bharatanatyam: A Reader*, edited by Daves Soneji. New Delhi: Oxford University Press.

- Harman, William P. 2004. "Taming the Fever Goddess: Transforming a Tradition in Southern India." *Manushi* 140: 2–13.
- Harman, William P. 2006. "Negotiating Relationships With the Goddess." In *Dealing With Deities: The Ritual Vow in South Asia*, edited by Selva J. Raj and William P. Harman. Albany: SUNY Press.
- Kottai Mariamman. 2001. Rama Narayanan Dir. Perf. Roja, Devayani, and Vivek. VCD. 'Leaders Differ Over Padma Award for Bangaru Adigalar'. 2019. *The Hindu*, January 27. Accessed 28 March 2019. <https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/tamil-nadu/leaders-differ-over-padmaaward-for-bangaru-adigalar/article26101960.ece>
- Mahadevan, Mahalakshmi. 2016. "The Pedagogy and Practice of En-Gendering Civic Engagement: Reflections on Serial-Viewing Among Middle-Class Women in Urban India." In *Gendered Citizenship and the Politics of Representation*, edited by Hilde Danielsen, Kari Jegerstedt, Ragnhild Muriaas, and Brita Ytre-Arne. London: Palgrave Macmillan.
- Meyer, Eveline. 1986. *A k aparam cuvari: A Goddess of TamilNadu, Her Myths and Cult*. Stuttgart: Steiner Verlag Wiesbaden GMBH.
- Mines, Diane P. 2005. *Fierce Gods: Inequality, Ritual and the Politics of Dignity in a South Indian Village*. Bloomington: Indiana University Press.
- Pillai, Sreedhar. 2015. "Have Ghosts Taken Over Kollywood?" *The Hindu*, September 5. Accessed 19 May 2019. <https://www.thehindu.com/features/cinema/have-ghosts-taken-over-kollywood/article7619470.ece>
- Punathambekar, Aswin, and Pavitra Sundar. 2017. "The Time of Television: Broadcasting, Daily Life, and the New Indian Middle Class." *Communication, Culture & Critique* 10 (3): 401–421. doi:10.1111/cccr.12164.
- Raja Kaliyamman. 2000. Rama Narayanan Dir. Perf. Karan, Kousalya, and Ramya Krishnan. DVD.
- Ram, Kalpana. 2008. "Bringing the Amman Into Presence in Tamil Cinema: Cinema Spectatorship as Sensuous Apprehension." In *Tamil Cinema: The Cultural Politics of India's Other Film Industry*, edited by Selvaraj Velayutham. New York: Routledge.
- Saavala, Minna. 2010. *Middle-Class Moralities: Everyday Struggle Over Belonging and Prestige in India*. New Delhi: Orient Blackswan.
- Sankaran, Chitra. 2015. "Materiality, Devotion and Compromise: A Study of Goddess Films of South India." *Material Religion* 11 (4): 443–464. doi:10.1080/17432200.2015.1103470.
- Smith, H. Daniel, and M. Narasimhachary. 1997. *Handbook of Hindu Gods, Goddesses and Saints: Popular in Contemporary South India*. Delhi: Sundeep Prakashan.
- Soneji, Daves. 2010. "Critical Steps: Thinking Through Bharatanatyam in the Twenty-First Century." In *Bharatanatyam: A Reader*, edited by Daves Soneji. New Delhi: Oxford University Press.
- Srinivas, Tulasi. 2018. *The Cow in the Elevator: An Anthropology of Wonder*. Durham: Duke University Press.
- Van Wessel, Margit. 2004. "Talking About Consumption: How an Indian Middle Class Dissociates from Middle-Class Life." *Cultural Dynamics* 16 (1): 93–116.
- Waghorne, Joanne Punzo. 2004. *Diaspora of the Gods: Modern Hindu Temples in an Urban Middle-Class World*. New York: Oxford University Press.
- Younger, Paul. 2010. *New Homelands: Hindu Communities in Mauritius, Guyana, Trinidad, South Africa, Fiji, and East Africa*. New York: Oxford University Press.

- Alphen, Ernst van. 2013. "Affect." In *Images That Move*, edited by Patricia Spyer and Mary Margaret Steedly. Santa Fe: School for Advanced Research, Advanced Seminar Series.
- Athique, Adrian. 2009. "Leisure Capital in the New Economy: The Rapid Rise of the Multiplex in India." *Contemporary South Asia* 17 (2): 123–140.
- Athique, Adrian. 2011. "From Cinema Hall to Multiplex: A Public History." *South Asian Popular Culture* 9 (2): 147–160.
- Beelen, Karl, Roos Gerritsen, and A. Srivathsan. 2010. "Climbing Up the Rank Ladder." *MONU: Magazine on Urbanism*.
- Christopher, Nilesh. 2019. "TikTok Is Fuelling India's Deadly Hate Speech Epidemic." *Wired UK*, August 12. Accessed 15 August 2019. <https://www.wired.co.uk/article/tik-tok-india-hate-speech-caste>
- Dhreshwar, Vivek, and R. Srivatsan. 2010. "'Rowdy-Sheeters': An Essay on Subalternity and Politics." In *Subaltern Studies IX: Writings on South Asian History and Society*, edited by Shadid Amin and Dipesh Chakravarty. New Delhi: Oxford University Press.
- Dickey, Sara. 1993. *Cinema and the Urban Poor in South India*. Cambridge Studies in Social and Cultural Anthropology. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press.
- Gerritsen, Roos. 2015. "Chennai Beautiful: Shifting Urban Landscapes and the Politics of Spectacle." In *Visual Homes, Image Worlds: Essays from Tasveer Ghar, the House of Pictures*. New Delhi: Yoda Press. <http://www.tasveergharindia.net/cmsdesk/essay/115/index.html>
- Gerritsen, Roos. 2016a. "Intimacy on Display: Movie Stars, Images and Everyday Life in South India." *Visual Anthropology* 29 (4–5): 382–405.
- Gerritsen, Roos. 2016b. "Keeping in Control: The Figure of the Fan in the Tamil Film Industry." *Studies in South Asian Film and Media* 7 (1–2): 5–23.
- Gerritsen, Roos. 2019. *Intimate Visualities and the Politics of Fandom in India*. Amsterdam: Amsterdam University Press.
- The Hindu*. 2019. "Ban TikTok Mobile Application: Ramadoss." January 2, sec. Tamil Nadu. Accessed 3 January 2019. <https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/tamil-nadu/ban-tiktok-mobile-application-ramadoss/article25885031.ece>
- Hirschkind, Charles, Maria José, A. de Abreu, and Carlo Caduff. 2017. "New Media, New Publics? An Introduction to Supplement 15." *Current Anthropology* 58 (S15): S3–S12.
- Jeffrey, Craig. 2010. *Timepass: Youth, Class, and the Politics of Waiting in India*. Stanford: Stanford University Press.
- Nakassis, Constantine V. 2017. "Rajini's Finger, Indexicality, and the Metapragmatics of Presence." *Signs and Society* 5 (2): 201–242.
- The New Indian Express*. 2019. "After Simbu Tells Fans to Pour Pots of Milk on His Cut-Outs, Milk Dealers Approach Commissioner for Protection." *The New Indian Express*, January 23. Accessed 4 February 2019. <http://www.newindianexpress.com/entertainment/tamil/2019/jan/23/after-simbu-tells-fans-to-pour-pots-of-milk-on-his-cut-outs-milk-dealers-approach-commissioner-for-1929119.html>
- Pandian, M.S.S. 1992. *The Image Trap: M.G. Ramachandran in Film and Politics*. New Delhi: Sage.
- Pillai, Sreedhar. 2016. "Out With the Old." *The Hindu*, February 27, sec. Cinema. Accessed 30 February 2019. <https://www.thehindu.com/features/cinema/how-film-distribution-has-changed-with-times-in-kollywood/article8289535.ece>
- Pillai, Sreedhar. 2019. "Will the Real Kollywood Fan Please Stand Up?" *The Hindu*, February 1, sec. Movies. Accessed 03 February 2019. <https://www.thehindu.com/entertainment/movies/will-the-real-kollywood-fan-please-stand-up/article26146973.ece>

- Prasad, M., and Madhava. 2014. *Cine-Politics: Film Stars and Political Existence in South India*. New Delhi: Orient Blackswan.
- Punathambekar, Ashwin. 2007. "Between Rowdies and Rasikas: Rethinking Fan Activity in Indian Film Culture." In *Fandom: Identities and Communities in a Mediated World*, edited by J. Gray, C. Sandvoss, and C.L. Harrington. New York: New York University Press.
- Rajanayagam, S. 2015. *Popular Cinema and Politics in South India: Reimagining MGR and Rajinikanth*. New Delhi: Routledge.
- Rogers, Martyn. 2009. "Between Fantasy and 'Reality': Tamil Film Star Fan Club Networks and the Political Economy of Film Fandom." *South Asia: Journal of South Asian Studies* 32 (1): 63–85.
- Searle, Llerena Guiu. 2016. *Landscapes of Accumulation*. Chicago: The University of Chicago Press.
- Spyer, Patricia, and Mary Margaret Steedly. 2013. *Images That Move*. Santa Fe: School for Advanced Research Advanced Seminar Series.
- Srinivas, Lakshmi. 2010. "Ladies Queues, 'Roadside Romeos', and Balcony Seating: Ethnographic Observations on Women's Cinema-Going Experiences." *South Asian Popular Culture* 8 (3): 291–307.
- Srinivas, Lakshmi. 2016. *House Full: Indian Cinema and the Active Audience*. Chicago: University of Chicago Press.
- Srinivas, S.V. 2007. *Is There a Public in the Cinema Hall?* <http://www.sarai.net/mediacity/filmcity/essays/srinivas.html>.
- Srinivas, S.V. 2009. *Megastar: Chiranjeevi and Telugu Cinema After N. T. Rama Rao*. New Delhi: Oxford University Press.
- Srinivas, S.V. 2016. "Rajinikanth and the 'Regional Blockbuster'." In *Chicago Tamil Forum*.
- Vasudevan, Ravi. 2004. "Disreputable and Illegal Publics: Cinematic Allegories in Times of Crisis." In *Sarai Reader 04: Crisis/Media*, edited by Monica Narula, Shuddhabrata Sengupta, Ravi Sundaram, Ravi S. Vasudevan, Awadhanendra Sharan, Jeebesh Bagchi, and Geert Lovink. Sarai: The New Media Initiative, CSDS.
- Derrida, Jacques. 1994. *Specters of Marx*. Translated by P. Kamuf. London: Routledge. Translated of *Spectres de Marx*. Paris: Galilee, 1993.
- Dtnext.in. 2019. "Power-Hogging Sodium Vapour Street Lights Will Soon Be a Thing of the Past." *Dtnext*, January 30.
- Gopal, Sangita. 2011. *Conjugations: Marriage and Form in New Bollywood Cinema*. Chicago: University of Chicago Press.
- Hagglund, Martin. 2014. "The Necessity of Discrimination: Disjoining Derrida and Levinas." *Diacritics* 34 (1): 40–71.
- IANS, Chennai. 2014. "Southern Cinema's Uncredited Film Adaptations." *Businessstandard.com*, November 12. Accessed 28 May 2019. https://www.business-standard.com/article/news-ians/southern-cinema-s-uncredited-film-adaptations-114111200512_1.html
- Kaali, Sundar. 2000. "Narrating Seduction: Vicissitudes of the Sexed Subject in Tamil Nativity Film." In *Making Meaning in Indian Cinema*, edited by Ravi Vasudevan. New Delhi: Oxford University Press.
- Kamath, Sudhish. 2003. "Making Films for the Real World." *Thehindu.com*, January 2. <https://www.thehindu.com/1f/2003/01/02/stories/2003010206620200.htm>
- Krishnan, Rajan. 2008. "Imaginary Geographies: The Makings of the 'South' in Contemporary Tamil Cinema." In *Tamil Cinema: The Cultural Politics of India's Other Film Industry*, edited by Selvaraj Velayutham. London: Routledge.

- Kurai, Rajan. 2012. *Kathanayaganin Maranam/Death of a Hero*. Chennai: Kayal Kavin Pathippagam.
- Pandian, M.S.S. 1992. *The Image TRAP*. New Delhi: Sage Publications.
- Ramnath, Nandini. 2018. "'Mercury' Film Review: Karthik Subbaraj's Film Doesn't Walk the Talk." *Scroll.in*, April 13. Accessed 20 February 2019. <https://scroll.in/article/875477/mercury-film-review-karthik-subbarajs-thriller-doesnt-walk-the-talk>
- Vimarsanakuzhu, Vikatan. 2018. "Kadaikutty Singam: Cinema Vimarsanam/Kadaikutty Singam: Cinema Review." *Vikatan.com*, July 25. Accessed 24 February 2019. <https://www.vikatan.com/anandavikatan/2018-jul-25/cinema-news/142672-kadaikutty-singam-movie-review.html>
- Baskaran, Theodore. 1981. *The Message Bearers: The Nationalist Politics and the Entertainment Media in South India, 1880–1945*. Chennai: Cre-A.
- Baskaran, Theodore. 1996. *The Eye of the Serpent: An Introduction to Tamil Cinema*. Chennai: East West Books.
- Bureau, F.B.J. 2017. "Tamil Nadu: A Virtually Orphan State." *The Free Press Journal*, December 29. Accessed 14 February 2019. <https://www.freepressjournal.in/editorspick/tamil-nadu-a-virtually-orphan-state/1195447>
- Chinniah, Sathiyavathi. 2008. "The Tamil Heroine: From a Passive Subject to a Pleasurable Project." In *Tamil Cinema: The Cultural Politics of India's Other Film Industry*, edited by Selvaraj Velayutham. London: Routledge.
- Chopra-Gant, Mike. 2006. *Hollywood Genres and Post-War America: Masculinity, Family and Nation in Popular Movies and Film Noir*. London: I B Taurius Publishers.
- Cody, Francis. 2016. "Populist Publics: Print Capitalism and Crowd Violence Beyond Liberal Frameworks." In *Media and Utopia: History, Imagination and Technology*, edited by Arvind Rajagopal and Anupama Rao. London: Routledge.
- Deeksha, Johanna. 2017. "Inside Rajmohan's Mind: Everything You Wanted to Know About the Man Who Asks the Questions on Tamil Nadu's Mind." *Edex*, September 26. Accessed 5 April 2019. <https://www.edexlive.com/live-story/2017/sep/26/presenting-rajmohan-arumugam-the-man-from-put-chutney-who-makes-you-sit-up-and-listen-to-him-1221.html>
- Derné, Steve. 2000. *Movies, Masculinity, and Modernity: An Ethnography of Men's Filmgoing in India*. Westport: Greenwood Press.
- Dickey, Sara. 1993. *Cinema and Urban Poor in South India*. London: Cambridge University Press.
- Express Web Desk. 2018. "Sarkar Director AR Murugadoss Applies for Anticipatory Bail: Reports." *The Indian Express*, November 9. Accessed 9 January 2019. <https://indianexpress.com/article/entertainment/tamil/sarkar-director-ar-murugadoss-anticipatory-bail-5438833/>
- Gupta, Vishnu. 2018. "What's Driving Our Taste for Explicitly Nationalistic Cinema?" *Wire.in*, December 12. Accessed 3 February 2019. https://livewire.thewire.in/out-and-about/whats-driving-our-taste-for-explicitly-nationalistic-cinema/?fbclid=IwAR0kMjzR0UvUkVfXmoPPKsHotnAVKbuCpAfWJxTUS1_-vldXMR4AC-9C6U
- Hansen, Miriam. 1993. "Early Cinema, Late Cinema: Permutations of the Public Sphere." *Screen* 34 (3): 197–210.
- Hardgrave Jr, Robert. 1973. "Politics and the Film in TamilNadu: The Stars and the DMK." *Asian Survey* 13 (3): 288–305.
- Hardgrave Jr, Robert, and Anthony C. Neidhart. 1975. "Films and Political Consciousness in Tamil Nadu." *Economic and Political Weekly* 10 (1–2): 27–35.

- Jacob, Preminda. 2008. *Celluloid Deities: The Visual Culture of Cinema and Politics in South India*. Lanham: Lexington.
- Jayakumar, Babu. 2017. "Jallikattu Protests Are an Uprising Against a Failed Political System." *Hindustan Times*, January 21. Accessed 21 March 2019. <https://www.hindustantimes.com/analysis/jallikattu-protests-are-an-uprising-against-a-failed-political-system/story-tJlsgWFZRYhmpvKBWav6HO.html>
- Krishnan, Rajan. 2008. "Imaginary Geographies: The Makings of 'South' in Contemporary Cinema." In *Tamil Cinema: The Cultural Politics of India's Other Film Industry*, edited by Selvaraj Velayutham. New York: Routledge.
- Manovich, Lev. 2001. *Language of New Media*. Cambridge: The MIT Press.
- Muralidharan, Kavitha. 2017. "Seven Tectonic Shifts in Tamil Nadu Politics After Jayalalithaa's Death." *Hindustan Times*, December 5. Accessed 19 January 2019. <https://www.hindustantimes.com/india-news/a-year-after-jayalalithaa-s-death-tamil-nadu-s-political-landscape-is-all-topsy-turvy/story-xR5gGWk6gWDAqvITwbinAK.html>
- Pandian, Anand. 2008. "Cinema in the Countryside: Popular Tamil Film and the Remaking of Rural Life." In *Tamil Cinema: The Cultural Politics of India's Other Film Industry*, edited by Selvaraj Velayutham. New York: Routledge.
- Pandian, M.S.S. 1991. "Parasakthi: Life and Times of a DMK Film." *Economic and Political Weekly* 26 (11): 759–770.
- Pandian, M.S.S. 1992. *The Image Trap*. New Delhi: Sage.
- Pillai, Sreedhar. 2018. "Vijay's Sarkar Eyes Blockbuster Opening With Massive Advance Booking, Shows in 3000 Screens Across India." *Firstpost.com*, November 2. Accessed 15 April 2019. <https://www.firstpost.com/entertainment/vijays-sarkar-eyes-blockbuster-opening-with-massive-advance-booking-shows-in-3000-screens-across-india-5492371.html>
- Pillai, Sreedhar. 2019. "'Ayogya' to '100': Why Financial Issues Continue to Plague Tamil Cinema." *The Hindu Metroplus*, July 23. Accessed 18 February 2019. <https://www.thehindu.com/entertainment/movies/ayogya-to-100-why-financial-issues-are-plaguing-tamil-cinema/article27127856.ece?homepage=true>
- Pratt, David B. 1994. "'We Must Make the Government Tremble': Political Filmmaking in the South Indian State of Tamil Nadu." *The Velvet Light Trap* 34: 10–39.
- Rajanayagam, S. 2015. *Popular Cinema and Politics in South India: The Films of MGR and Rajinikanth*. New Delhi: Routledge.
- Ramani, Srinivasan. 2017. "The More Things Change... Comment." *The Hindu*, March 2. Accessed 12 May 2019. <https://www.thehindu.com/opinion/op-ed/the-more-things-change/article17388869.ece>
- Ranganathan, Maya. 2015. "Television Politics: Evolution of Sun TV in the South." In *Indian News Media: From Observer to Participant*, edited by Usha M. Rodrigues and Maya Ranganathan. New Delhi: Sage Publications.
- Ranganathan, Maya and Selvaraj Velayutham. 2012. "Imagining Eelam Tamils in Tamil Cinema." *Continuum: Journal of Media and Cultural Studies* 26 (6): 871–881.
- Shimpach, Shawn. 2007. "Representing the Public of the Cinema's Public Sphere." In *Media and Public Spheres*, edited by Richard Butsch. London: Palgrave Macmillan.
- Sivathamby, Karthigesu. 1981. *The Tamil Film as a Medium of Political Communication*. New Delhi: New Century Book House.
- Subramanian, Narendra. 1999. *Ethnicity and Populist Mobilization; Political Parties, Citizens and Democracy in South India*. New Delhi: Oxford University Press.
- Upadhyaya, Prakash. 2018. "Sarkar Box-Office Collection (Worldwide): Vijay-Keerthi Suresh Starrer Ends 14-Day Second Weekend on a High Note." *IBT*, November 19.

- <https://www.msn.com/en-in/entertainment/southcinema/sarkar-box-office-collection-worldwide-vijay-and-keerthys-film-ends-14-day-second-weekend-on-high-note/ar-BBPRugc>
- Anon. 2018. "44 Tamil Channels Crossed 1M Subscribers on YouTube." *The Hindu*, (Business Line). Accessed 10 December 2019. <https://www.thehindubusinessline.com/m/news/variety/44-tamil-channels-crossed-1m-subscribers-on-youtube/article25711857.ece>
- Bahree, M. 2019. "India's New Rules to Govern Social Media Raise Fears of More Censorship." *Forbes*, January 22. Assessed 15 April 2020. <https://www.forbes.com/sites/meghabahree/2019/01/22/indias-new-rules-to-govern-social-media-raise-fears-of-more-censorship/#4f417b426759>
- Brennen, J.S. and D. Kreiss. 2016. "Digitalization." In *The International Encyclopedia of Communication Theory and Philosophy*, edited by Klaus Bruhn Jensen and Robert T. Craig. New Jersey: JohnWiley & Sons, Inc.
- Brouwer, B. 2018. "India Was Positively Obsessed With YouTube Last Month: Top YouTube Channels November 2018." *Tubular Insights*, December 17. <https://tubularinsights.com/top-youtube-channels-november-2018/>
- Casetti, F. 2012. "The Relocation of Cinema." *NECSUS: The European Journal of Media Studies* 1 (2): 5–34.
- Cunningham, S. 2015. "The New Screen Ecology: A New Wave of Media Globalisation?" *Communication Research and Practice* 1 (3): 275–282.
- Cunningham, S., D. Craig, and J. Silver. 2016. "YouTube, Multichannel Networks and the Accelerated Evolution of the New Screen Ecology." *Convergence: The International Journal of Research Into New Media Technologies* 22 (4): 376–391. <https://doi.org/10.1177/1354856516641620>.
- Kandavel, S. 2019. "Are Big Tamil Film Production Houses Eyeing Digital Streaming Market?" *The Hindu*, March 2. Accessed 19 April 2019. <https://www.thehindu.com/entertainment/are-big-tamil-film-production-houses-eyeing-digital-streaming-market/article26418449.ece>
- Keshavdev, V. 2019. "The Rise of the OTTs." *Outlook Business*, April 10. Accessed 10 April 2019. <https://www.outlookbusiness.com/the-big-story/lead-story/the-rise-of-the-otts-5001>
- Krishna, N. 2018. "YouTube Channels in Regional Languages Are Growing and How." *The Hindu*, October 27. Accessed 8 February 2019. <https://www.thehindu.com/society/youtube-channels-in-regional-languages-are-growing-and-how/article25335529.ece>
- Kumar, S. 2016. "YouTube Nation: Precarity and Agency in India's Online Video Scene." *International Journal of Communication* 10: 5608–5625.
- Laghate, G. 2018. "3 Indian Content Creators Cross 10M Subscriber Mark on YouTube." December 7. Accessed 10 March 2019. <https://tech.economictimes.indiatimes.com/news/internet/3-indian-content-creators-cross-10m-subscriber-mark-on-youtube/66980461>
- Mohan, S. and Punathambekar, A. 2018. "Localizing YouTube: Language, Cultural Regions, and Digital Platforms." *International Journal of Cultural Studies*. <https://doi.org/10.1177/1367877918794681>.
- Murali, A. 2018. "Amala Akkineni to Star With Sunainaa in a New Web Series." *Silverscreen India*, November 29. Accessed 10 June 2019. <https://silverscreen.in/news/amala-akkineni-to-star-with-sunainaa-in-a-new-web-series/>
- Naig, U. 2014. "Net Gain for Short Film." *The Hindu*, April 16. Accessed 12 June 2019. <https://web.archive.org/web/20140416193729/http://www.thehindu.com/features/cinema/cinema-reviews/net-gain-for-short-film/article5918894.ece>

- Pillai, S. 2018. "With Emerging Digital Platforms, Tamil Cinema Scrambles to Adapt." *The Hindu*, January 16. Accessed 19 April 2019. <https://www.thehindu.com/entertainment/movies/with-emerging-digital-platforms-tamil-cinema-scrambles-to-adapt/article22450764.ece>
- Pillai, S. 2019. "Digital Streaming Has Disrupted the Tamil Cinema Business." *The Telegraph*, March 14. Accessed 15 March 2019. <https://www.telegraphindia.com/entertainment/digital-streaming-has-disrupted-the-tamil-cinema-business/cid/1686828>
- Rajendran, G. 2018. "Streaming Success: Tamil Film Production Houses to Look for Web Series." *The New Indian Express*, April 21. Accessed 20 April 2019. <http://www.newindianexpress.com/entertainment/tamil/2018/apr/21/streaming-success-tamil-film-production-houses-to-look-for-web-series-1804220.html>
- Rhea. 2018. "What Brands Can Learn from YouTube Brandcast 2018." *Social Beat*, March 28. <https://www.socialbeat.in/blog/youtube-brandcast-2018/>
- Saravanan, T. 2016. "Karthik on a Roll." *The Hindu*, September 8. Accessed 20 April 2019. <https://www.thehindu.com/features/cinema/Karthik-on-a-roll/article14628542.ece>
- Snickars, P. and P. Vonderau. 2009. *The YouTube Reader*. Stockholm: Kungliga Biblioteket.
- Sudevan, P. 2019. "For the Love of Tamil Cinema." *The Hindu*, April 11. Accessed 19 April 2019. <https://www.thehindu.com/entertainment/movies/for-the-love-of-tamil-cinema/article26807768.ece>
- TNN. 2019a. "Sivakarthykeyan Assembles YouTube Stars for a Song in His Production." March 1. Accessed 21 April 2019. <https://timesofindia.indiatimes.com/entertainment/tamil/movies/news/sivakarthykeyan-assembles-youtube-stars-for-a-song-in-his-production/articleshow/68220626.cms>
- TNN. 2019b. "YouTube Star Harija to Be a Part of 'SK13'." February 1. Accessed 21 April 2019. <https://timesofindia.indiatimes.com/entertainment/tamil/movies/news/youtube-star-harija-to-be-a-part-of-sk13/articleshow/67794803.cms>
- Velayutham, S., ed. 2008. *Tamil Cinema: The Cultural Politics of India's Other Film Industry*. London: Routledge.
- Vikas, S.N. 2014. "On AVM Productions Releasing Direct-To-Internet Movie on YouTube." *Medianama*. Accessed 14 April 2019. <https://www.medianama.com/2014/04/223-avm-productions-direct-to-internet-movie-youtube/>